

STRATEGIC GROWTH BLUEPRINT · 2026–2027

Website Audit, European Go-to-Market & the Automation Operating System.

A build-order for a two-person, part-time software company turning an EU legal entity into European revenue — without quitting the day job.



SUBJECT
nexarrow.eu

AUDITED
8 August 2026

ENTITY
Reg. 17521430 · VAT EE102992676

HORIZON
90 days · 12 months

CONTENTS

What is in this document, and how to use it.

§	SECTION	DECIDES	PG
01	Verdict & headline findings Where the business actually stands today	Priority	3
02	Website audit Scorecard, 5 critical defects, 7 high-priority defects	Sprint 1 scope	4–7
03	Conversion & positioning The funnel that does not exist; message rewrite	Copy & UX	8–9
04	Website remediation plan Three sprints, effort vs. impact, definition of done	Weeks 1–6	10
05	The European opportunity Rate bands, demand drivers, country prioritisation	Where to sell	12–13
06	ICP, wedge & offer ladder Who to target, why you win, what you sell, at what price	Offer design	14–16
07	12-month GTM roadmap Phased plan with gates you must pass to advance	Sequencing	18
08	Marketing engine Channels, funnel arithmetic, content system, EU email law	Weekly output	19–23
09	Capacity & resource model Part-time hours, the 60% rule, the timezone unlock, roles	Commitments	25–27
10	Automation blueprint Architecture, build order, tool stack and true cost	What to build	28–30
11	Operating cadence & 90-day board Rituals, owners, the actual task list	Monday morning	31–32
12	KPIs, finance, risk & next 14 days Targets, money model, what can kill this, start here	Control	33–36

READ THIS FIRST

The document is a build-order, not a menu.

Sections are sequenced by dependency. Marketing spend before the website captures leads is wasted. Outbound before proof exists converts at near zero. Do them in order.

Method & evidence base

- Live inspection of `nexarrow.eu` — rendered DOM, HTTP status codes, response headers, meta tags, performance timings.
- All eight public routes crawled plus probe requests for `/sitemap.xml`, `/robots.txt`, `/llms.txt` and invalid slugs.
- Every defect on pages 5–7 is reproducible. The reproduction step is printed beside it.
- Market figures are cited inline; delivery and capacity figures are modelled and labelled as estimates.

Core assumptions

Operators	2, part-time
Realistic capacity each	12–18 h / week
Contracting entity	Estonian OÜ, VAT-registered
Delivery base	India (IST, UTC+5:30)
Target market	EU / EEA B2B
Starting proof assets	Zero

If any assumption is wrong, the capacity model on page 25 and the financial model on page 34 are the two things to re-run first.

01 · EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

The site is well-designed and commercially non-functional.

Design, copy tone and structure are above the standard of most small agency sites. But the site cannot be crawled beyond its homepage, cannot capture a lead, and offers a buyer no evidence that Nexarrow has ever shipped anything. Those three gaps — not aesthetics — are what stand between the company and its first European client.

LINKS CRAWLABLE

0

No `<a>` element exists anywhere on the site. Navigation is 100% JavaScript buttons.

LEAD CAPTURE POINTS

0

No form, no booking link, no phone. One Gmail address.

PROOF ASSETS

0

No case study, client name, logo, testimonial, or named human.

ARTICLES PROMISED / LIVE

6 / 0

Every “Read more” returns the homepage under a 200 status.

THE SIX THINGS THAT MATTER

- 01 Google can only see one page.** Zero anchor tags plus a missing `sitemap.xml` means seven of your eight pages have no discoverable path in. Your services pages — the ones that would rank — are invisible.
- 02 A visitor who wants to hire you cannot.** The contact page offers `thenexarrow@gmail.com` and nothing else. Site-wide form count is zero. Every euro of future marketing spend leaks out here.
- 03 There is no evidence you have done this before.** The “Solutions” block describes hypothetical projects, not delivered ones. For a €10,000+ decision made remotely, an unproven vendor is a non-starter.
- 04 The Insights section actively damages trust.** Six articles are listed with titles, dates and read-times. None exist. A prospect who clicks lands back on the homepage — the worst possible signal.
- 05 Your single strongest asset is not on the website.** You are an EU-registered, EU-VAT company. For a German or Dutch buyer that removes procurement friction an Asian supplier cannot remove. You never say it.
- 06 The positioning fits everyone, so it attracts no one.** “Software · SaaS · AI · Cloud ... worldwide” is the same sentence as ten thousand competitors. Nothing here helps a buyer self-identify.

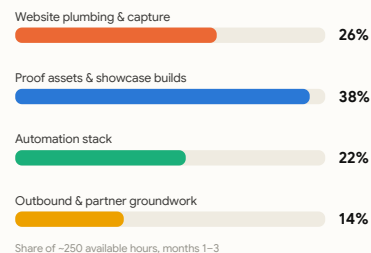
THE ONE BIG IDEA

Sell the EU entity, not the code.

Anyone can write React. Very few small suppliers can hand a European buyer an EU-domiciled contract, an EU VAT reverse-charge invoice, and a GDPR data-processing agreement governed by EU law — with no third-country transfer paperwork. That is a procurement advantage, it is already paid for, and it is currently invisible.

Where the effort should go

Share of the first 90 days of available hours



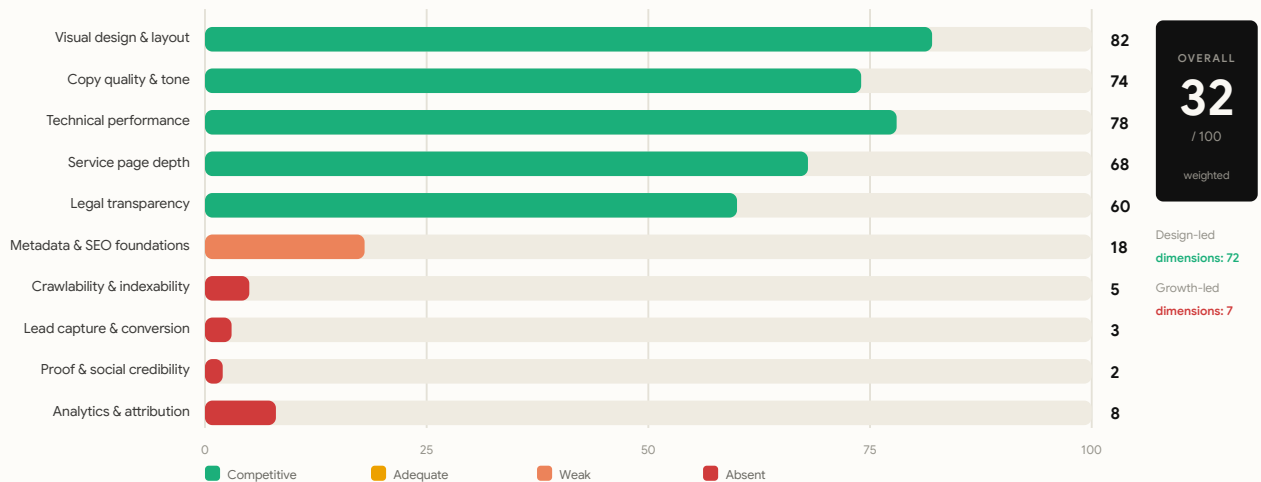
02 · WEBSITE AUDIT

Scorecard: strong craft, broken commercial plumbing.

Ten dimensions, scored 0–100 against what a European B2B buyer and a search crawler each need to find. The pattern is consistent: everything a designer controls scores well; everything a growth operator controls scores near zero.

Nexarrow website readiness index

0 = absent · 100 = competitive for EU B2B software services. Overall weighted score in the panel at right.



▲ Keep — do not touch

- **Visual design and layout.** Restrained, confident, better than category average.
- **Copy tone.** Plain, non-hyperbolic, credible. Rare and valuable.
- **Service page depth.** `/services/[slug]` pages are real, substantive and correctly 404 on bad slugs.
- **Technical performance.** 418 KB, 15 requests, 1.55 s load, 426 ms TTFB. No action needed.
- **Legal transparency.** Registry code and VAT number published. Most competitors hide this.

■ Fix — high leverage

- **Crawlability.** Buttons → anchors, plus a sitemap. One day of work, unlocks everything.
- **Capture.** Form, booking, real domain email.
- **Per-page metadata.** Eight pages currently share one title.
- **Link previews.** No Open Graph tags — every LinkedIn share renders grey and unclickable.
- **Structured data.** A 12-question FAQ is sitting there unmarked.

✗ Remove or replace now

- **Six phantom articles** on `/insights`. Publish two real ones or delete the section.
- **Gmail address** as the only contact route.
- **Design-brief copy** left in production on the careers page.
- **Dead “Terms & Conditions” link** in the footer of every page.
- **“Worldwide”** as a positioning word. It is costing you Europe.

02.1 · SEVERITY: CRITICAL

Five defects that block revenue and indexing.

Each is reproducible in under a minute. Each has a fix measured in hours, not weeks. Together they are the reason the site produces no pipeline.

#	DEFECT & HOW TO REPRODUCE IT	BUSINESS CONSEQUENCE	FIX & EFFORT
C1	CRITICAL Site has zero hyperlinks Navigation, footer, service cards and CTAs are all <code><button></code> with JS handlers. <code>document.querySelectorAll('a').length</code> returns 0 on every page.	Crawlers follow anchors, not click handlers. Your internal link graph does not exist, so no PageRank flows and seven of eight pages are effectively unreachable by Google. Users also lose middle-click, open-in-new-tab, copy-link and back-button behaviour.	Replace every navigational button with <code><Link href></code> rendering a real <code><a></code> . Keep the styling. 4–6 h. Mechanical, no design risk. Until it ships, every SEO or content investment compounds against a wall.
C2	CRITICAL Phantom blog — any slug returns the homepage under HTTP 200 <code>/insights/zzz-fake-slug-test</code> → 200 OK, serving homepage HTML. All six “Read more” buttons behave this way.	Two harms. Commercially, a prospect who clicks an article is dumped on the homepage — it reads as a fake company. Technically it is an unlimited soft-404 surface: infinite URLs returning duplicate content at 200, wasting crawl budget and diluting indexing.	Either publish the six articles as real pages, or delete the section and return a hard 404 on unknown slugs. 2 h to remove · 12–18 h to publish. Removing it today stops the trust damage immediately.
C3	CRITICAL No lead capture of any kind <code>document.querySelectorAll('form').length</code> = 0 site-wide. <code>/contact</code> shows only <code>thenexarrow@gmail.com</code> .	The two CTAs — “Start a Project” and “Talk to Nexarrow” — have nowhere to land. A buyer must compose a cold email to a Gmail account. Realistically a majority of interested visitors abandon here, and you have no record they were ever there.	Qualifying form (6 fields) + Cal.com booking + <code>hello@nexarrow.eu</code> , with an auto-reply inside 60 seconds. 6–8 h. Every euro of future marketing spend leaks out of this gap.
C4	CRITICAL No sitemap; identical metadata across all 8 pages <code>/sitemap.xml</code> → 404. Every route returns the same <code><title></code> and description. No <code>canonical</code> anywhere.	With C1, discovery has no fallback path at all. Identical titles give Google no reason to rank any individual page and invite duplicate-content consolidation — your brand search result shows the same line whichever page wins.	Next.js <code>sitemap.ts</code> + <code>generateMetadata()</code> per route + canonical tags. Submit in Search Console. 4 h. Do it in the same sitting as C1.
C5	CRITICAL Zero credibility assets No case study, client name, logo, testimonial, headshot, founder name or team page across all 8 routes. Homepage “Solutions” are hypotheticals.	The largest single conversion blocker, and no amount of traffic fixes it. A European SME committing five figures to a remote supplier needs to see delivered work and a named human who is accountable. Currently neither exists.	Three self-funded showcase builds, two named founders, one process teardown — the plan on page 9. 3–5 weeks, in parallel. Do not write case studies for work you have not done. Everything else here is plumbing; this one is the product.

02.2 · SEVERITY: HIGH & MEDIUM

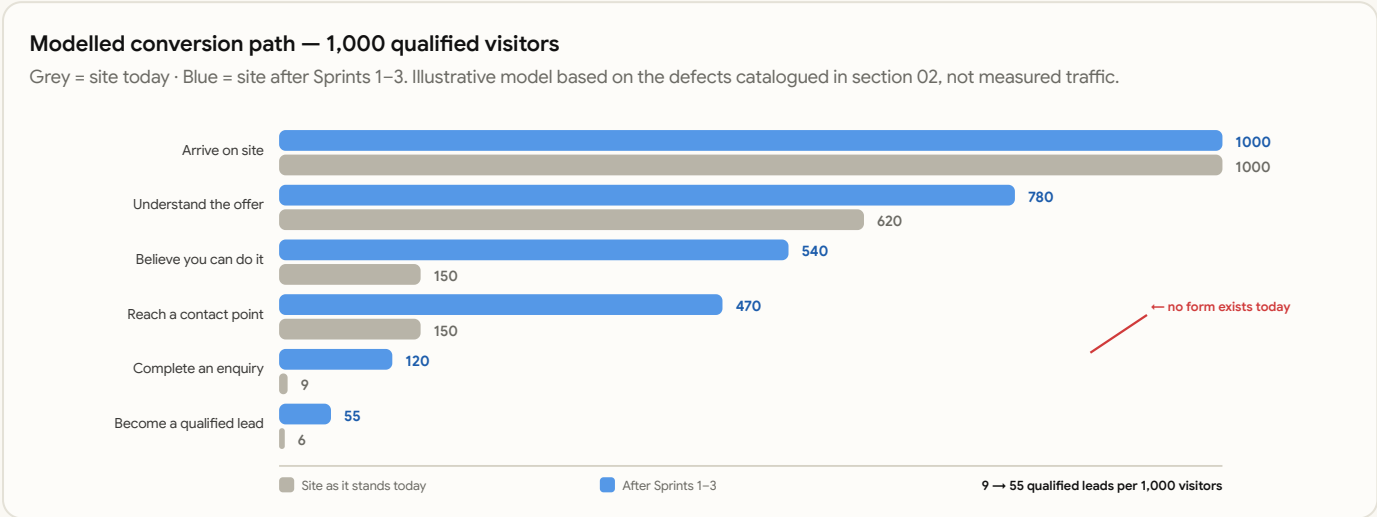
Twelve further defects, ordered by what they cost you.

#		DEFECT & EVIDENCE	CONSEQUENCE	FIX	EFFORT
H1	HIGH	No Open Graph or Twitter Card tags. All <code>og:*</code> and <code>twitter:*</code> meta absent.	Every link you or a prospect shares on LinkedIn, Slack, WhatsApp or Teams renders as a bare grey URL with no image or title. For a company whose primary channel will be LinkedIn and email, this silently halves click-through on every share you will ever make.	Static OG image per route + full OG/Twitter meta in <code>generateMetadata()</code> .	3 h
H2	HIGH	No structured data anywhere. Zero <code>application/ld+json</code> blocks — despite a 12-question FAQ block on the homepage.	You forgo FAQ rich results, Organization knowledge-panel eligibility, and Service markup. You are also invisible to AI answer engines, which increasingly lean on structured data — a channel that now sends real B2B services traffic.	<code>Organization</code> + <code>ProfessionalService</code> + <code>FAQPage</code> + <code>Service</code> ×4. Add <code>/llms.txt</code> .	4 h
H3	HIGH	Design-brief text shipped as production copy. Careers page reads: “A clear hiring page should explain the role, the work, and the path.”	This is the specification for the page, not the page. Any careful reader — a candidate or a prospect doing diligence — recognises unfinished work and generalises it to how you would deliver their project.	Delete the block. Replace with hiring process, timeline, and a real application form.	2 h
H4	HIGH	Footer links to a page that does not exist. “Terms & Conditions” → <code>/terms</code> returns 404. Present on all 8 pages.	A broken legal link on every page is the kind of detail EU procurement and legal reviewers check. It also weakens the Privacy Policy that sits next to it.	Publish Terms, plus a DPA template and sub-processor list — all three are assets in EU sales.	4 h + review
H5	HIGH	Brand and delivery model contradict each other in public. Site brands as Tallinn, Estonia. Careers page advertises “Remote / India-friendly”.	A European buyer who reads both pages concludes the Estonian presence is a shell and stops trusting the rest of the site. The model itself is completely fine — the concealment is the problem , and it is self-inflicted.	Own it explicitly: “EU contracting entity in Tallinn; engineering team in India; overlapping European hours.” Sell it as page 16 describes.	3 h
H6	HIGH	Contact address is a free Gmail account. <code>thenexarrow@gmail.com</code> on <code>/contact</code> , while you own <code>nexarrow.eu</code> .	Reads as a side project rather than a company. It also means no shared inbox, no aliases, no deliverability reputation on your own domain, and no basis for the outbound programme in section 08.	Google Workspace on <code>nexarrow.eu</code> ; <code>hello@</code> , <code>sales@</code> , named founder addresses. SPF, DKIM, DMARC.	2 h
H7	HIGH	No analytics or conversion tracking. Only the Cloudflare Insights beacon. No goals, no source attribution.	You cannot tell which page, campaign or country produces enquiries, so every marketing decision in the next 12 months would be made blind and no channel could be shut off with confidence.	Plausible or GA4 + form/booking events + UTM discipline + Search Console.	3 h
M1	MEDIUM	No pricing signal of any kind.	Without a stated minimum engagement you attract unqualified enquiries and lose serious buyers who filter for budget fit. For a part-time team, an unqualified call is the most expensive thing you can spend an evening on.	Publish indicative bands and a minimum engagement (page 17).	2 h
M2	MEDIUM	English only.	Germany is the largest EU market and German-language buyers strongly prefer German-language suppliers. Not urgent — but it caps the German plan in section 05 until addressed.	Phase 2: German landing page + German case study. Not a full site translation.	Phase 2
M3	MEDIUM	No named humans. No founder, no team, no photos, no LinkedIn links.	B2B services are bought from people. An anonymous supplier raises the perceived risk of a remote engagement and makes founder-led LinkedIn — your cheapest channel — impossible to connect back to the company.	Two founder profiles with real names, photos and LinkedIn links.	3 h
M4	MEDIUM	Careers page advertises 4 roles with no application mechanism.	“Apply now” has the same dead end as “Start a Project”. Wasted intent, and it makes the roles look decorative.	Simple application form or a mailto with structured subject line.	2 h
M5	MEDIUM	No consent layer prepared for analytics. Currently compliant only because Cloudflare Insights is cookieless.	Becomes a genuine GDPR exposure the moment H7 adds analytics or the C3 form starts storing personal data — exactly the compliance detail an EU buyer will test you on.	Cookieless analytics (Plausible) avoids a banner entirely. Add a privacy notice to the form.	2 h

03.1 · CONVERSION ARCHITECTURE

You have a brochure. You need a funnel.

Modelled below: 1,000 qualified European visitors arriving at the site as it stands today, against the same 1,000 arriving after the fixes in section 02. The drop-offs are not estimates of your traffic — they are estimates of what each structural gap costs at each step.



WHERE THE LEAKS ARE, AND WHAT PLUGS THEM

STAGE	WHAT BREAKS IT TODAY	THE FIX
Arrival	Only the homepage is discoverable (C1, C4). Shared links render as grey text (H1). Fewer people ever arrive.	Anchors, sitemap, per-page metadata, OG images.
Orientation	“Software · SaaS · AI · Cloud ... worldwide” gives a buyer nothing to recognise themselves in.	Named ICP and named outcome in the hero (page 9).
Belief	Nothing to believe. No delivered work, no client, no named human (C5, M3). Phantom articles actively subtract trust (C2).	Three showcase builds, two founder profiles, one teardown.
Intent	No pricing signal, so budget-fit buyers cannot self-select and everyone else hesitates (M1).	Published bands and a stated minimum engagement.
Action	Nowhere to click. Zero forms. One Gmail address (C3, H6).	Form + Cal.com + hello@nexarrow.eu + 60-second auto-reply.
Follow-through	No CRM, no tracking, no sequence. An enquiry that is not answered within a day is usually lost.	CRM + automated 5-touch follow-up (section 10).

THE NUMBER THAT MATTERS

≈ 9x

Modelled uplift in qualified enquiries per 1,000 visitors, from the same traffic, with no additional marketing spend. This is why section 02 comes before section 08 — **fixing capture multiplies every channel you build later.**

Response-time rule

For part-time operators this is the single most important operational commitment on the whole site, and the reason automation in section 10 is not optional.

Automated acknowledgement	< 60 seconds
Human reply	< 12 working hours
Call offered within	3 working days
Proposal after discovery	< 5 working days

You will not beat a full-time agency on availability. You can beat most of them on *predictability* — if the automation guarantees the first touch while you are at your day job.

03.2 · POSITIONING & MESSAGE

Stop selling capabilities. Start selling a decision.

Your current homepage describes what you can build. A buyer is not shopping for capabilities — they are trying to resolve a specific problem with acceptable risk. Rewrite the top of the site around the decision they are making.

TODAY

“Building scalable software for modern business growth.”

Nexarrow helps companies design, build, and scale custom software, SaaS platforms, AI-powered products, and cloud infrastructure... for businesses worldwide.

- True of roughly every software company that exists.
- No buyer, no problem, no geography, no proof, no risk-reversal.
- “Worldwide” signals *no* particular market — the opposite of the EU advantage you already hold.
- Four services with equal weight means no wedge and no searchable specialism.

RECOMMENDED

“Custom internal software for European SMEs — contracted through an EU entity, built by a team that works your afternoon.”

Nexarrow OÜ is an Estonian software company. We replace the spreadsheets, email chains and disconnected tools that European operations teams run on, with software built around how the business actually works. EU contract, EU VAT, GDPR-native delivery, EU-hours coverage.

- Names the buyer (European SME operations), the problem (manual internal process) and the wedge (EU contracting).
- Answers the two objections a remote supplier always gets: *who am I contracting with*, and *when are you awake*.
- “Internal software” is a real search category with commercial intent and far less competition than “software development”.
- Leaves SaaS, AI and Cloud intact as supporting services — they stop competing for the headline.

WEDGE 1 · PRIMARY

Internal operations software

Approvals, records, scheduling, reporting, quoting, field data — the systems European SMEs still run on spreadsheets.

CompetitionLow

Budget availabilityHigh

Fit to your stated skillsDirect

Sales cycle4–10 weeks

Least glamorous, most winnable. Lead with this.

WEDGE 2 · GROWTH

AI workflow automation with EU data residency

Retrieval, document handling and assistants embedded in real approval and action paths — hosted in the EU, documented for the AI Act.

CompetitionRising fast

Budget availabilityVery high

Regulatory tailwindEU AI Act

Sales cycle6–12 weeks

Highest price ceiling. Requires the strongest proof — build here second.

WEDGE 3 · OPPORTUNISTIC

Compliance-driven integration work

e-invoicing and digital reporting readiness under ViDA, plus NIS2-driven logging, access and observability work.

CompetitionLow

Budget availabilityMandated

DriverDeadline, not desire

Sales cycle2–6 weeks

Regulation removes the “why now” objection entirely. Fastest close in the portfolio.

Pick one wedge for the homepage headline. Keep all three as services. A specialist that also does other things wins; a generalist that specialises in nothing does not get shortlisted.

POSITIONING

08

03.3 · THE PROOF PROBLEM

How to get case studies when you have no clients.

This is the chicken-and-egg that stops most new agencies, and there is a standard way through it: stop waiting for clients to generate proof and manufacture it yourself. Six weeks of evenings produces enough evidence to sell against.

THE FIVE PROOF ASSETS, IN BUILD ORDER

- 01 Your own automation stack, documented.** You are about to build the systems in section 10 for yourselves. Write that up with real screenshots and real hours-saved numbers. It is a genuine case study about a real client — you — and it proves exactly the capability you are selling.
- 02 Three showcase builds.** Small, real, deployed, usable. Each targets one ICP pain: an approvals tool, a quote-to-invoice flow, a document-retrieval assistant with EU hosting. Open the demo, publish the architecture note, state the build time.
- 03 Two written teardowns.** Take a public process problem in your target vertical, analyse it properly, show how you would build the fix. This is what the phantom Insights articles were supposed to be. Two real ones beat six fake ones by an infinite margin.
- 04 Two founder profiles.** Names, photographs, LinkedIn links, what each person is accountable for. Non-negotiable for remote five-figure deals.
- 05 Discounted first client.** One deliberately under-priced engagement in exchange for a named reference, a logo and a metric. Budget 30–40% off list. Do this **once**, contract the reference in writing, then never again.

Proof asset build sequence

Weeks 1–8, evenings and weekends only



RULE

Never publish a case study for work you did not do, and never list an article that does not exist.

You are already doing the second one. It is the cheapest credibility you will ever recover — deleting the six phantom entries takes two hours and immediately stops the damage.

Case study template — one page, six blocks, no adjectives

01 CONTEXT

Company size, country, sector, the system they ran before. Two sentences.

02 PROBLEM, QUANTIFIED

Hours lost, errors made, revenue delayed. A number, not a feeling.

03 WHAT WE BUILT

Plain description plus one architecture diagram. Stack listed, decisions justified.

04 HOW LONG, WHAT IT COST

Real weeks, real price band. Buyers screen on this before anything else.

05 RESULT

The same metric from block 02, measured after. If you cannot measure it, say so.

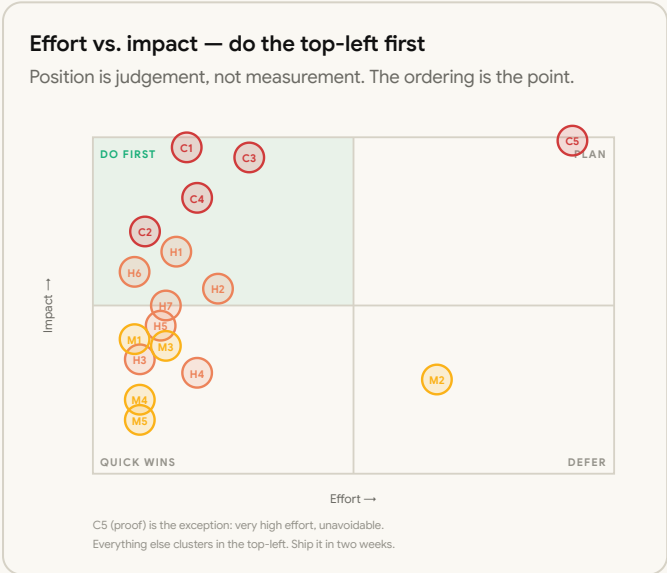
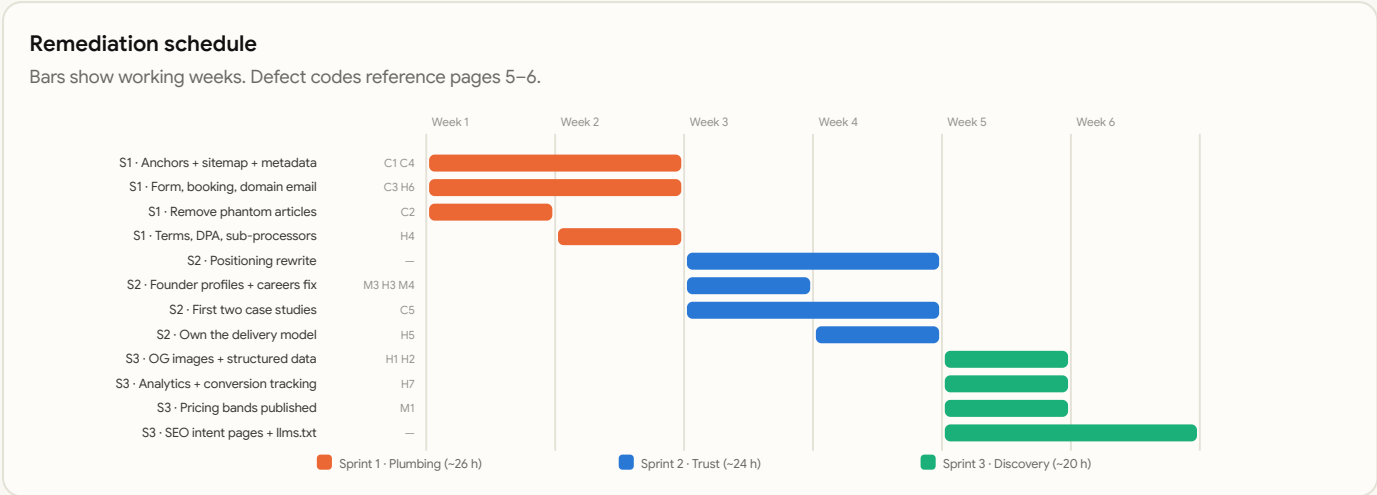
06 WHAT WE WOULD CHANGE

One honest limitation. This single block builds more trust than the other five combined.

04 · WEBSITE REMEDIATION PLAN

Three sprints, six weeks, roughly 70 evening hours.

Sequenced so that each sprint makes the next one worth doing. Nothing here requires a redesign — the design is the part that works.

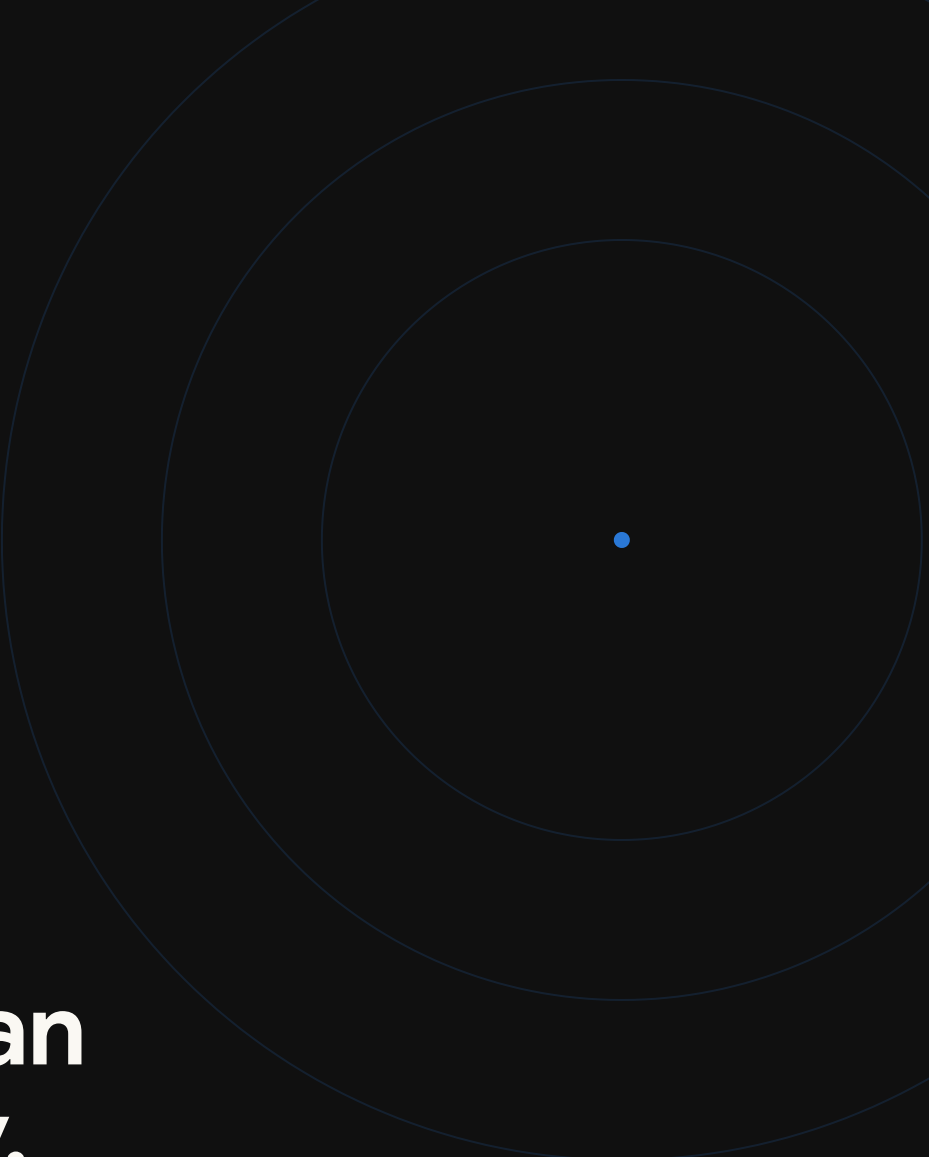


DEFINITION OF DONE — SPRINT 1

- ☐ `document.querySelectorAll('a').length` is greater than 40 on the homepage
- ☐ `/sitemap.xml` returns 200 and lists all 8 routes
- ☐ Every route has a unique `<title>`, description and canonical
- ☐ An invalid `/insights/*` slug returns a hard 404
- ☐ Contact form posts to CRM and fires an auto-reply within 60 seconds
- ☐ Cal.com booking live, availability restricted to CET afternoons
- ☐ `hello@nexarrow.eu` live with SPF, DKIM and DMARC passing
- ☐ Footer “Terms & Conditions” resolves to a real page
- ☐ OG image renders correctly in the LinkedIn Post Inspector
- ☐ Search Console verified and sitemap submitted

Sprint 1 — Plumbing	~26 h · Weeks 1–2
Sprint 2 — Trust	~24 h · Weeks 3–4
Sprint 3 — Discovery	~20 h · Weeks 5–6
Total	~70 h

At 15 hours per week each across two people, this is comfortably achievable in six weeks alongside proof-asset work — provided no client delivery is running. That is the argument for doing it *now*, before the first client arrives.



05

PART TWO

The European opportunity.

Where the demand is, what it pays, which countries to enter in what order — and the procurement advantage you already own and have never used.

\$66

avg. hourly rate,
Western Europe

124k

IT professionals short,
Germany alone

77%

of German outsourcers
buy inside Europe

18%

go to Asia
— your whole thesis

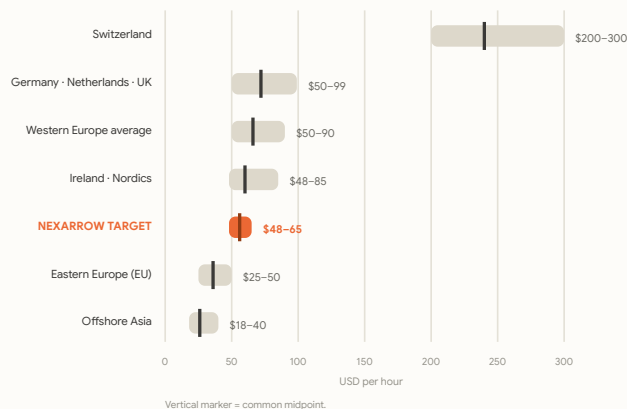
05.1 · MARKET STRUCTURE

Price where the EU entity does the work.

European buyers face a genuine talent shortage and a strong preference for suppliers inside the Union. That combination is the entire opportunity — and it means you should not price like an offshore supplier.

Prevailing hourly rate bands by supplier origin

USD per hour, developer-level. Bars show typical range; marker shows the common midpoint. Sources listed on page 36.



RECOMMENDED POSITION

€48–65 /hour

Clearly below a German or Dutch local shop. Clearly above a pure offshore quote. The gap is justified by the EU contract, the EU VAT invoice and EU-hours coverage — which is exactly the story pages 8 and 16 tell.

Why not compete on price

- At €25–35/hour you are compared against Eastern European suppliers who are inside the EU, in the same time zone, and cheaper to manage. You lose that comparison.
- Low rates attract price-led buyers, who are the most demanding and the least loyal — the worst possible client for a part-time team.
- **Fixed-price packages beat hourly rates** for you. They hide your true hourly, reward speed, and cap the buyer's risk. Quote packages; use the hourly band only for retainers.

DEMAND DRIVER 01

Structural talent shortage

Germany is short roughly **124,000** IT professionals. Shortage means projects that are funded but unstaffed — the easiest kind of work to win, because you are not displacing an incumbent.

DEMAND DRIVER 02

Strong in-Europe preference

77% of German enterprises that outsource development do so within Europe, against **18%** to Asia. Your Estonian entity moves you from the 18% bucket into the 77% bucket *on the contract* — at no extra cost.

DEMAND DRIVER 03

Regulatory forcing functions

The EU AI Act, NIS2 and ViDA e-invoicing all create work with deadlines attached. Deadline-driven budgets close faster because “why now” is answered by law rather than by your sales skill.

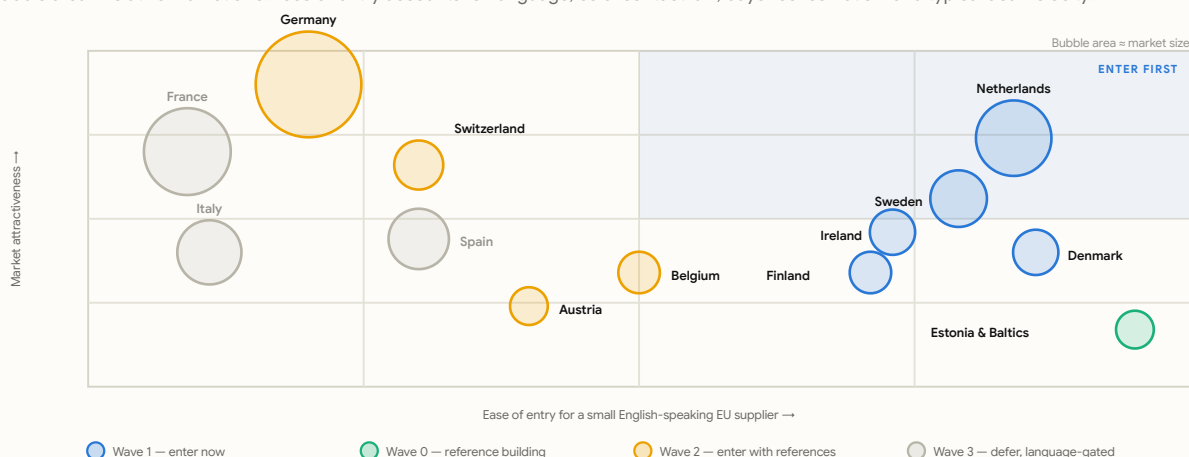
05.2 · WHERE TO ENTER, IN WHAT ORDER

Netherlands and the Nordics first. Germany second.

Not because Germany is smaller — it is by far the largest — but because Germany requires German-language assets and has the strictest cold-contact rules in the Union. Win somewhere English-speaking first, then enter Germany with references in hand.

Market attractiveness vs. ease of entry for a small, English-speaking, EU-registered supplier

Bubble area ≈ relative market size. Ease of entry accounts for language, cold-contact law, buyer conservatism and typical deal velocity.



MARKET	WAVE	RATE BAND	LANGUAGE	WHY / CAUTION	ENTRY MOTION
Netherlands	WAVE 1	€50–80	English fine	Highest English fluency in continental Europe, pragmatic buyers, short decision chains, high digital maturity, comfortable with remote suppliers. The single best beachhead.	Cold email + LinkedIn + agency partnerships
Sweden · Denmark · Finland	WAVE 1	€48–75	English fine	English-native business culture, high trust in Estonian and Baltic tech, strong existing Nordic–Estonian commercial ties. Slower in July–August; plan around it.	LinkedIn-led + Nordic tech communities
Ireland	WAVE 1	€50–80	English	English-speaking, dense tech ecosystem, EU member. Smaller absolute market and heavily served by local suppliers, but low friction to test.	Cold email + subcontracting to local shops
Estonia · Baltics	WAVE 0	€30–50	English fine	Your home entity — easiest credibility, fastest first reference, but low rates and a small market. Use it to manufacture the first two case studies , not to build the business.	e-Residency & startup networks, local events
Germany	WAVE 2	€55–95	German expected	Largest market and the biggest shortage, but: German-language sales materials are effectively required, buyers are conservative and reference-driven, and B2B cold email is legally restrictive (see page 23). Enter with references, in German, via LinkedIn and partners.	Partner-led + LinkedIn. Not cold email.
Belgium · Austria · Switzerland	WAVE 2	€55–120	Mixed	Switzerland carries the highest rates in Europe by a wide margin but is the hardest to enter without a local presence. Treat as opportunistic upside, never as a plan.	Inbound and referral only
France · Spain · Italy	Wave 3	€40–70	Local language required	Large markets, but a strong local-language expectation makes them uneconomic for a two-person English-speaking team. Revisit only when you have a native-speaking partner or hire.	Defer

FOCUS DISCIPLINE

Two countries in Wave 1. Not seven.

With 30 combined hours a week you cannot research, message, localise and follow up across seven markets. Pick the Netherlands and one Nordic country. Everything — landing pages, prospect lists, case study language, LinkedIn network building — points at those two for the first six months.

THE ESTONIA PARADOX

Your registered market is your worst-paying one and your best-converting one. Use it deliberately: take one or two Estonian or Baltic projects at local rates purely to generate named references and a real Estonian business address story — then sell those references into the Netherlands and the Nordics at 1.6× the price.

06.1 · IDEAL CUSTOMER PROFILE

The company that hires you looks like this.

Precision here is what makes 60 prospects a week outperform 600. Every filter below removes someone who was never going to buy from a two-person part-time supplier.

✓ TARGET

Size	25–250 employees. Big enough to have real process pain and a budget; small enough that one person can decide.
Revenue	€3m–€60m
Sectors	Logistics & freight · manufacturing & industrial services · professional services · wholesale & distribution · healthcare services · construction & field services
Tech posture	Has software, but no internal product team. Runs a patchwork of SaaS plus a large amount of Excel.
Buyer	Operations Director · COO · Head of Finance · a founder still involved in operations. Not a CTO — a CTO builds in-house.
Deal size	€8,000–€30,000 first project, converting to a €4,000–€9,000 monthly retainer
Geography	Netherlands, Sweden, Denmark, Finland, Ireland, Estonia (waves 0–1)

✗ DISQUALIFY — SAY NO

- **Funded startups building their core product.** They need daily availability and same-day pivots. You cannot give either. This is the most tempting and most damaging client type for a part-time team.
- **Enterprises over 1,000 employees.** Procurement, security questionnaires, insurance minimums and vendor-onboarding cycles will consume months of capacity you do not have.
- **Anything under €5,000.** Fixed overhead per engagement — discovery, contracting, onboarding, reporting — makes small projects loss-making in hours.
- **“Build me an app like Uber” enquiries.** No budget, no specification, no decision-maker.
- **Buyers who lead with hourly rate.** They are shopping a spreadsheet and you are not the cheapest cell in it.
- **Regulated safety-critical or high-risk AI systems** in your first year. The AI Act conformity burden is real and you are not resourced for it yet.

The saying-no rule: with 30 hours a week, every yes to a bad fit is a no to a good one you have not met yet. Write these disqualifiers into the enquiry form so most of them never reach a call.

TRIGGER SIGNALS — THE REASON TO CONTACT THEM THIS WEEK

Hiring signals

- Posted a developer or “digital transformation” role for 45+ days
- Hiring an ops manager to “improve processes”
- First-ever internal IT hire

A stale developer posting means funded, unstaffed work. Highest-converting signal available.

Growth signals

- Funding round, acquisition or new-market entry
- New warehouse, branch or country
- Headcount up 20%+ year on year

Growth breaks manual processes. Reach them in the window where it hurts but before they hire.

Technology signals

- Public job ads listing a legacy stack
- Careers or portal pages that are visibly broken
- Announced an ERP or CRM migration

Migrations always create integration and internal-tooling gaps nobody owns.

Regulatory signals

- In a NIS2 in-scope sector
- Trading in a country with an imminent e-invoicing mandate
- Publicly announced an AI initiative

Deadline-driven. Removes the “not this quarter” objection entirely.

A message that opens with a specific, verifiable observation about their business outperforms a personalised-looking template by an order of magnitude. The research *is* the campaign — which is precisely why section 10 automates the research and never the message.

06.2 · COMPETITIVE WEDGE

Four advantages you already own and never mention.

None of these cost anything to activate. All four are already paid for — they exist because of decisions you have already made. They belong on the homepage, in the first outbound email, and on slide two of every proposal.

01 EU contracting entity

The buyer contracts with Nexarrow OÜ, an EU company, under EU law, with an EU registry code they can verify in a public register. For a cautious European operations director this eliminates the entire “what happens if it goes wrong with an overseas supplier” conversation — the objection that kills most offshore deals before price is ever discussed.

Say it as: “You contract with an Estonian company, registry 17521430. Disputes are governed by EU law.”

02 EU VAT, reverse charge

VAT EE102992676 means a VAT-registered buyer in another member state receives a clean intra-community invoice under the reverse-charge mechanism. No import complexity, no withholding questions, nothing unusual for their accountant to query. Finance departments approve familiar invoices faster — and finance is who actually releases the payment.

Say it as: “Standard intra-EU reverse-charge invoicing. Your finance team has processed a thousand of these.”

03 GDPR-native delivery

As an EU-established controller-processor you can sign a DPA under EU law and offer EU-region hosting by default. Where personal data genuinely stays in the EU there is no third-country transfer assessment to complete — the paperwork exercise that stalls procurement for weeks. Publish the DPA and sub-processor list on the site and you pre-empt the whole review.

Requires honesty: if engineers in India access production data, that *is* a transfer and must be documented properly. Do it correctly and it stays an advantage; hide it and it becomes a liability.

04 Genuine European-hours coverage

This is the one that sounds impossible and is actually true. Your evenings *are* the European working afternoon. 18:30–22:30 IST maps to roughly 14:00–18:00 in Central Europe. You can hold live calls, answer questions and ship fixes during your client's working day — every working day — without either of you leaving your day job. Almost no offshore supplier can say this credibly, and most European buyers assume you cannot.

Say it as: “We are online 14:00–18:00 CET every working day. Book any slot in that window.” See page 26.

HOW THE FOUR COMBINE INTO ONE SENTENCE

“An EU company you can verify, invoicing you the way you already invoice, holding your data under EU law, and online every afternoon of your working week.”

That sentence is worth more than any technology claim on your current homepage, because it answers the four questions a European buyer actually asks before they ask what you can build.

WHAT IT IS WORTH

Rate premium over pure offshore	1.5–2.0×
Procurement friction removed	Weeks
Cost to activate	€0
Currently visible on site	Nowhere

06.3 · PRODUCTISED OFFER LADDER

Four products, one path, priced for a part-time team.

Custom quoting is the enemy of part-time capacity — every bespoke proposal costs an evening. Productise the offer so the scope, price and effort are known before the call, and the ladder does the selling.

STEP 1 · ENTRY

Operations Diagnostic

€1,900

5 working days · mostly async

- 2 × 60-min interviews, EU afternoon
- Process and systems map
- Automation opportunity list, ranked by hours saved
- Costed build recommendation
- 15-page written report

Why it exists: a paid first step filters tyre-kickers, funds the sales process, and gives you the information to scope accurately. Credit the full fee against any build started within 60 days.

STEP 2 · CORE

Internal Tool Build

€9,500–€18,000

5–8 weeks · fixed scope, milestone-billed

- One workflow, end to end
- Roles, permissions, audit trail
- Two integrations with existing systems
- EU-region deployment and CI/CD
- Handover documentation and 30-day warranty

Billing: 40% on signature, 30% at mid-milestone, 30% on acceptance. Never bill in arrears — cash-flow gaps are fatal at this size.

STEP 3 · PREMIUM

AI Workflow Pod

€14,000–€28,000

6–10 weeks · fixed scope

- Retrieval over their real documents
- Assistant wired into approvals and actions
- EU-hosted models and vector storage
- Evaluation harness with accuracy baselines
- AI Act documentation pack

The differentiator is not the model. It is EU hosting plus written evaluation evidence — the two things buyers cannot get from a generic AI vendor.

STEP 4 · GOAL

Managed Engineering

€3,900–€8,900/mo

Rolling · 3-month minimum · capped hours

- Fixed monthly hour bank (20 / 35 / 60 h)
- Named engineer, EU-afternoon availability
- Monthly written report, generated automatically
- Uptime and response commitments
- Unused hours roll one month, then expire

This is the whole point of the ladder. Retainers are the only revenue shape compatible with fixed weekly capacity. Every build must be sold with the retainer as its intended ending.

Revenue quality by offer

Retainers cost the least to win and the least to run. Weight the ladder towards them from month six.



Six pricing rules

- Never quote hourly to a new client. Quote the outcome; keep the hourly for retainer maths only.
- Always present three options. Buyers then choose between your options, not between you and a competitor.
- Publish a minimum engagement (€8,000). It disqualifies before it costs you an evening.
- Price in euros. Quoting in dollars undermines the entire EU wedge.
- Raise prices after every second reference. Proof is the only thing that justifies a rate rise.
- Charge for the diagnostic, always. Free discovery is where part-time teams quietly lose ten hours a month.

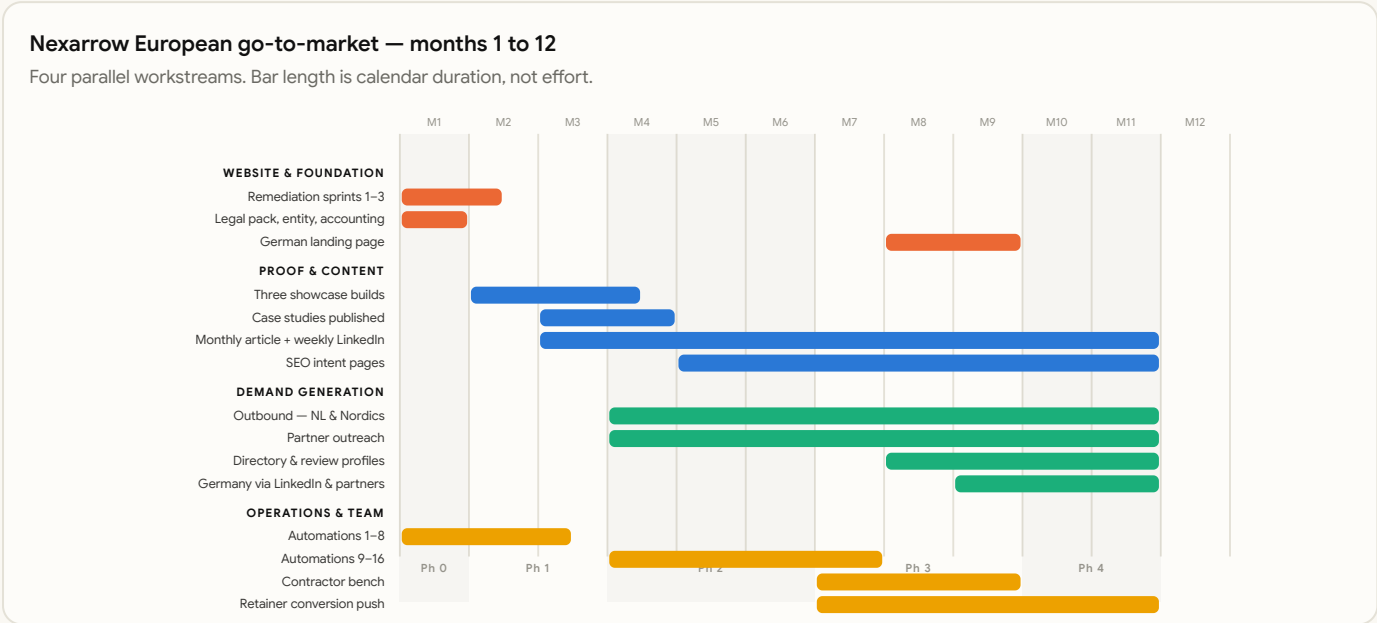
Scope-creep clause — put it in every contract

“Fixed scope covers the workflows listed in Appendix A. Additions are quoted as a change order at €65/hour with a revised delivery date.” Say it once at signature; omit it and it costs you the margin on your first three projects.

07 · GO-TO-MARKET ROADMAP

Five phases, twelve months, with a gate at every boundary.

Each phase has an exit condition. Do not begin the next phase until the gate is passed — the most common failure mode for part-time teams is running outbound before there is anything to convert with.



PH	PHASE & WINDOW	OBJECTIVE AND PRINCIPAL ACTIVITIES	GATE — DO NOT ADVANCE UNTIL
0	Foundation Months 1–2	Fix the website (section 04). Domain email, CRM, booking, analytics, tracking. Company LinkedIn plus two founder profiles rebuilt. Legal pack: Terms, DPA, sub-processor list, MSA template. Estonian accounting and invoicing set up properly.	Site is crawlable, capture works end to end, an enquiry reaches the CRM and triggers an auto-reply — tested by someone outside the team.
1	Proof Months 2–4	Three showcase builds shipped and deployed. Own automation stack documented as case study zero. Two written teardowns published. One discounted Baltic or Estonian engagement taken deliberately to secure a named reference.	Three case studies live on the site, at least one with a real named client and a real number.
2	First revenue Months 4–7	Outbound begins — 60 researched Dutch and Nordic prospects per week. Founder-led LinkedIn, three posts weekly. First partnership conversations with EU agencies and e-Residency service providers. Sell diagnostics before builds.	Three paid diagnostics completed and at least one converted into a build. Reply rate above 5%.
3	Repeatability Months 7–10	Convert completed builds into retainers. Two active referral partners producing leads. Contractor bench recruited and tested on real work. German-language landing page and first German assets. Clutch and directory profiles once real reviews exist.	Two retainers signed and a contractor has delivered billable work to your quality standard.
4	Scale or decide Months 10–12	Enter Germany with references. Raise prices. Decide the structural question: stay a high-margin boutique at this size, or one founder goes full-time and the company hires. Both are legitimate — but the decision must be made deliberately.	Recurring revenue covers one founder's salary requirement, or the decision is explicitly taken not to pursue that.

The gate that gets skipped

Phase 1 → 2. Starting outbound without proof feels productive and produces almost nothing. You burn your prospect list — and a Dutch logistics company you email badly in month three is not available again in month eight.

The phase that takes longest

Phase 1. Three real builds in evenings is genuinely hard. Budget ten weeks, not six, and keep each build deliberately small — a working narrow tool beats an unfinished broad one every time.

The phase that decides the company

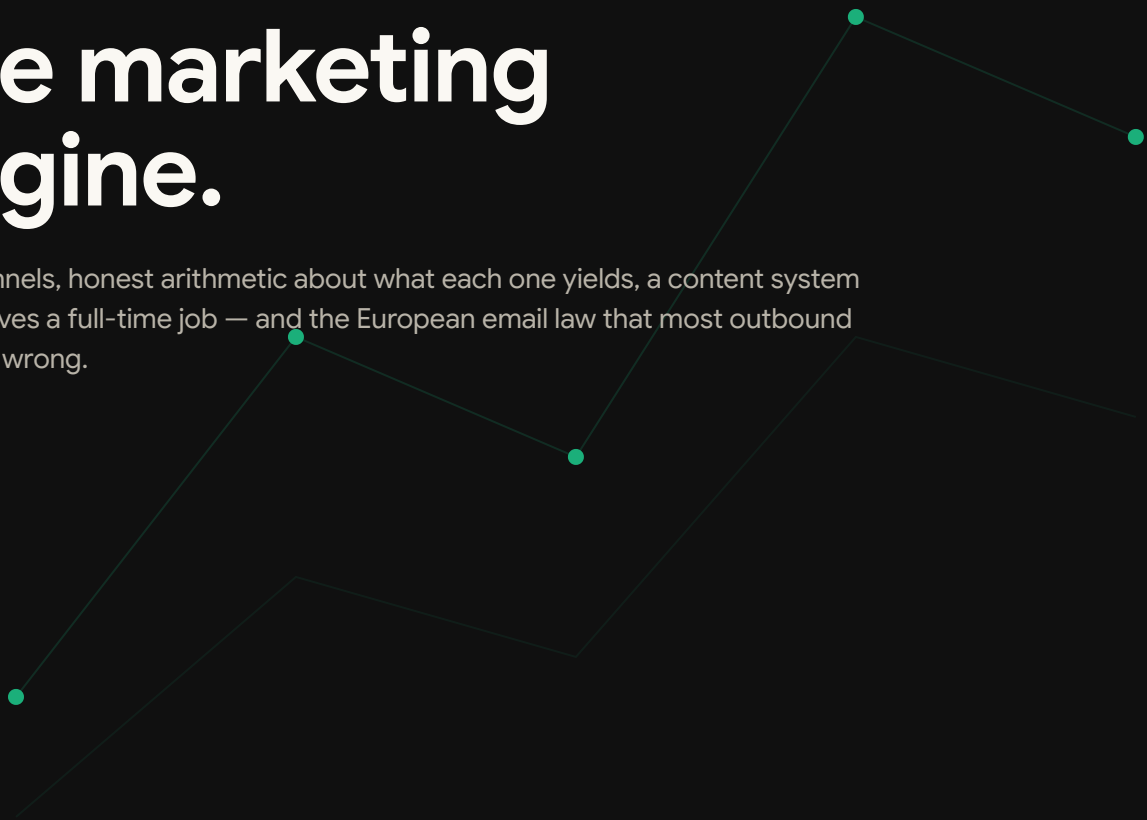
Phase 3. If you cannot make a contractor produce work you would put your name on, the business is permanently capped at two people's evenings. Test this early — it is the real constraint, not demand.

08

PART THREE

The marketing engine.

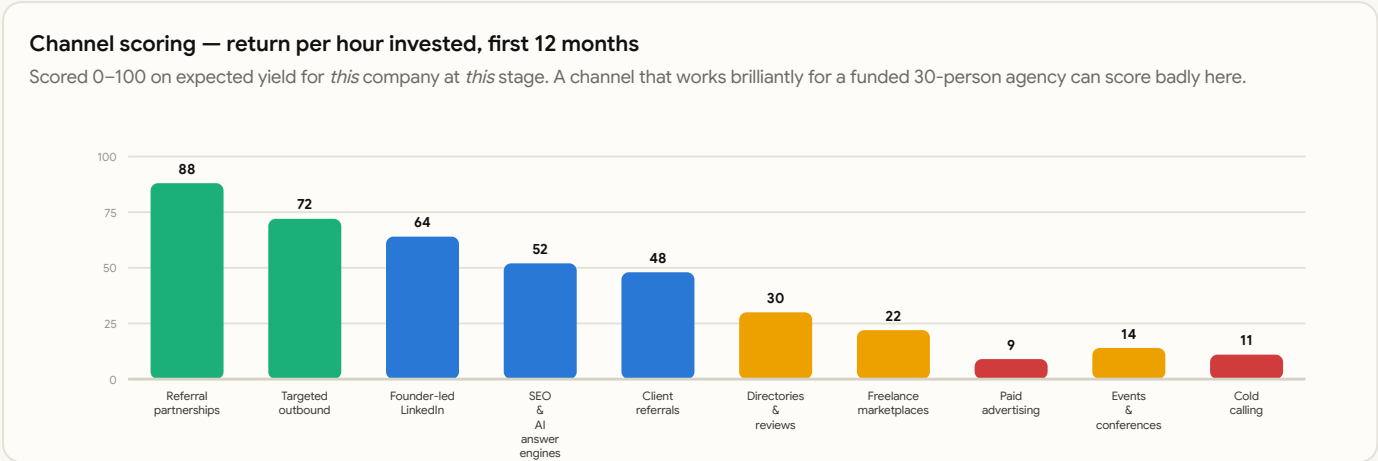
Four channels, honest arithmetic about what each one yields, a content system that survives a full-time job — and the European email law that most outbound plans get wrong.



08.1 · CHANNEL SELECTION

Four channels. Two you run weekly, two you compound.

With roughly 12 marketing hours a week between you, channel selection is mostly an exercise in refusal. Below: every realistic option, scored on what it actually returns for a part-time EU-registered supplier with no reputation yet.



CHANNEL	VERDICT	HOURS / WEEK	RATIONALE	FIRST RESULT BY
Referral partnerships EU design and digital agencies, fractional CTOs, e-Residency service providers, Nordic studios without dev capacity	RUN FIRST	3 h	The highest-return channel available to you, by a wide margin. One agency partner who lacks development capacity can send steady, pre-qualified, pre-trusted work with zero prospecting cost — and they sell for you, because their client already trusts them. Ten good conversations beat a thousand cold emails. It is also the only channel where being small is an advantage: agencies fear large dev partners poaching clients.	Weeks 6–12
Targeted outbound 60 researched prospects per week, Netherlands and Nordics	RUN WEEKLY	5 h	The only channel you fully control and the only one that produces pipeline on a schedule. It is also the most fragile: it requires real research per prospect, a warmed sending domain, and legal care by country (page 23). Volume without research yields nothing in 2026.	Weeks 4–8
Founder-led LinkedIn Personal profiles, 3 posts each per week	COMPOUND	3 h	Slow to start and then permanently useful. Critically, it makes outbound work better — a prospect who checks you after an email finds a real person with a visible track record instead of a blank profile. Post from personal profiles; company pages reach almost nobody.	Months 3–6
SEO & AI answer engines Long-tail intent pages, schema, llms.txt	COMPOUND	1 h	Cannot produce revenue this quarter and will produce it indefinitely afterwards. Blocked entirely until the crawlability fixes ship — which is the cheapest reason to do section 04 first. Target long-tail, low-competition, high-intent queries only.	Months 6–12
Directories & marketplaces Clutch, The Manifest, GoodFirms	LATER	—	Requires verified client reviews you do not yet have, and paid placement is expensive. Genuinely useful from month eight once two references exist. Listing early with an empty profile is worse than not listing.	Month 8+
Freelance platforms Upwork, Toptal and similar	TACTICAL	—	Price-led, review-gated, and it directly contradicts the EU-entity positioning that everything else here is built on. Defensible only as a deliberate short-term tactic to buy your first two reviews — never as a channel.	Optional
Paid advertising LinkedIn Ads, Google Ads	DO NOT	—	You would be paying to send traffic to a site with no proof and, until section 04 ships, no way to capture it. Revisit only when the funnel on page 7 is measured rather than modelled — and even then, LinkedIn's B2B costs are punishing at this deal size.	Not in year 1

The plan is 12 marketing hours a week: 5 outbound, 3 partnerships, 3 LinkedIn, 1 SEO. Everything else is deliberately refused until month eight.

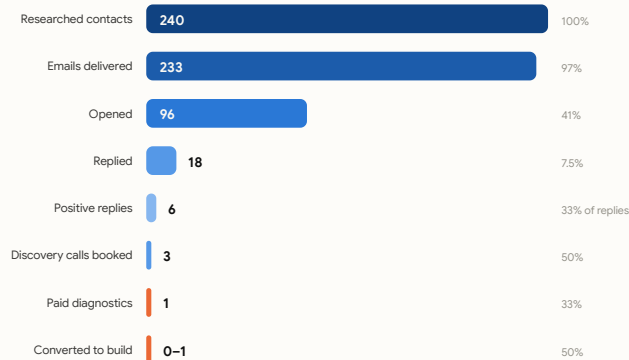
08.2 · THE ARITHMETIC, HONESTLY

What 60 emails a week actually produces.

Most growth plans fail because nobody multiplies the conversion rates out. Here they are, using conservative 2026 benchmarks for cold B2B outbound. The conclusion is uncomfortable and important.

Monthly outbound funnel — 240 researched contacts

Conservative rates for well-researched, low-volume cold outbound into EU B2B. Not for spray-and-pray volume, which converts far lower.



Per month, at 60 researched contacts per week.

THE UNCOMFORTABLE CONCLUSION

Outbound alone yields roughly one paid diagnostic a month and one build every two months.

That is not enough to hit a meaningful target, and no amount of effort inside the channel changes the arithmetic — doubling volume to 120 a week is not possible in five hours and would collapse the research quality that makes it work at all.

This is precisely why partnerships rank first on page 19. Two active referral partners can match the entire outbound programme for a third of the hours — and the leads arrive pre-trusted.

Combined realistic pipeline, month 9

Outbound	1.0 diagnostic / mo
Partnerships (2 active)	1.0–1.5 / mo
LinkedIn inbound	0.5 / mo
Referrals from clients	0.3 / mo
Total qualified opportunities	≈ 3 / month
Converting to builds	≈ 1.2 / month

Which is roughly the maximum a two-person part-time team can deliver anyway. The system is correctly sized — but only if all four channels run, not just the loudest one.

The five-touch sequence

- Day 1** **Observation email.** One specific, verifiable thing about their business. No pitch, no attachment, no calendar link. One question. Under 90 words.
- Day 4** **LinkedIn connection** from a founder profile. No note, or one line. Warms the name before the second email lands.
- Day 8** **Proof email.** One relevant case study, two sentences of context, the outcome number. Still no calendar link.
- Day 15** **Angle change.** Different pain, different entry point. Most replies arrive here — the first angle simply missed.
- Day 24** **Close the loop.** “I’ll stop here — reply to this thread if it becomes relevant.” Generates a surprising number of replies and protects the relationship.

Then stop. Do not re-enter the same contact for six months.

Deliverability — non-negotiable setup

- **Never send cold mail from** `nexarrow.eu`. Buy a separate sending domain such as `nexarrow-team.com`. If it gets burned, your real domain and your client mail survive.
- **Warm it for 3–4 weeks** before the first campaign. There is no shortcut and skipping it puts you in spam permanently.
- **SPF, DKIM and DMARC on both domains.** Missing DMARC alone materially reduces inbox placement.
- **Cap at 25–30 sends per mailbox per day.** Two mailboxes gets you to 60 a week comfortably.
- **Plain text only.** No images, no tracking pixels, no HTML signature. Tracking pixels hurt both deliverability and, in the EU, your legal position.
- **Working one-click unsubscribe** in every message. Legally necessary and it protects sender reputation.
- **Verify every address.** A bounce rate above 3% gets the domain throttled.

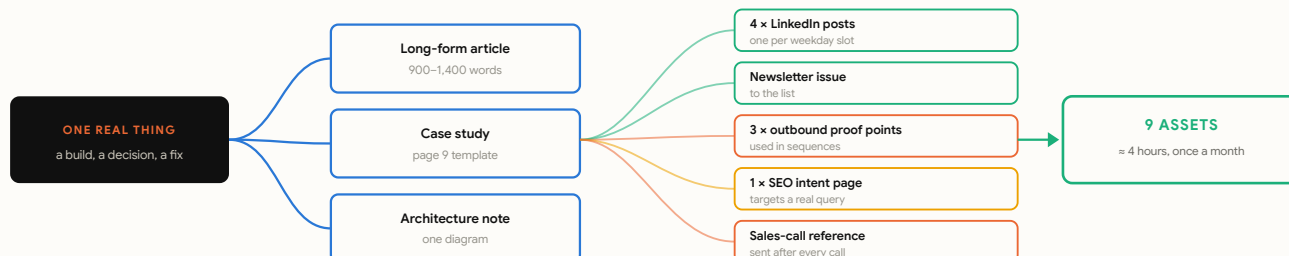
08.3 · CONTENT THAT SURVIVES A DAY JOB

One piece of real work a month. Nine outputs from it.

You cannot sustain a content calendar. You can sustain doing your job well once a month and harvesting it properly. Everything below comes from work you were going to do anyway.

The atomisation loop — one source, nine assets, roughly 4 hours

Monthly. The source is always real: a build you shipped, a problem you solved, a decision you made and can defend.



WEEKLY PUBLISHING RHYTHM — 3 HOURS TOTAL

SLOT	FORMAT	WHAT GOES IN IT	OWNER
Mon 20:00 IST	LinkedIn · founder A	A problem you saw in a real system, and how you would fix it. No promotion.	Delivery
Tue 20:00 IST	LinkedIn · founder B	A short operator lesson — pricing, scoping, a mistake you made and what it cost.	Demand
Thu 20:00 IST	LinkedIn · founder A	Something visual: a before/after screenshot, an architecture sketch, a real number.	Delivery
Fri 20:00 IST	LinkedIn · founder B	A short opinion on an EU-specific topic: AI Act, e-invoicing, EU hosting, data residency.	Demand
Last Sun	Site article + newsletter	The month's long piece, republished to the mailing list.	Both

Write all four posts in one Sunday sitting and schedule them. Never write on the day — that is how a content habit dies in week three. Posting time targets the European morning, which is your evening.

What to write about — ranked

- **Specific technical decisions with numbers.** “We cut this approval flow from 40 minutes to 3.” Highest engagement, highest credibility, hardest to fake.
- **EU-specific operating knowledge.** Data residency, AI Act documentation, reverse-charge invoicing. Very few technical people write about this and your buyers care about it.
- **Honest cost and pricing transparency.** What a build like this actually costs. Buyers hunting for this are high-intent and grateful.
- **Teardowns of bad internal software.** Recognisable, useful, and it demonstrates judgement rather than claiming it.
- **Avoid:** AI hot takes, “10 tips”, motivational founder content, anything reposted. It attracts other agencies, not buyers.

Where AI helps, and where it must not

Research and summarising	Yes
First-draft structure	Yes
Editing and shortening	Yes
Turning one post into nine	Yes
The opinion itself	No
Outbound first lines	No

Your buyers read AI-written content all day and recognise it instantly. The judgement has to be yours or the channel is worthless — and worse, it signals exactly the opposite of the “practical, honest” positioning your existing copy has earned.

08.4 · COMPOUNDING CHANNELS

Search, AI answers, and the partner playbook.

SEARCH — TARGET INTENT, NOT VOLUME

You will never rank for “software development company”. You can absolutely rank for queries that only a buyer with a wallet types. Build one page per query, each 900–1,400 words, each with a real example.

TARGET QUERY CLUSTER	COMPETITION	INTENT
gdpr compliant software development company eu	LOW	High
eu based development partner for [nl/nordic] company	LOW	High
custom internal tools development netherlands	MEDIUM	High
eu hosted ai assistant for business documents	LOW	High
peppol / e-invoicing integration developer	LOW	Very high
estonian software development company	LOW	Medium
replace spreadsheets with custom software cost	MEDIUM	High
nis2 logging and access control implementation	LOW	Very high

Every one of these is blocked until the crawlability fix ships. Publishing them before section 04 is complete means writing pages Google cannot reach.

AI ANSWER ENGINES — THE NEW REFERRAL SURFACE

A growing share of B2B supplier shortlisting now begins in an AI assistant rather than a search box. Being citable is a different discipline from ranking, and it is cheap to do well.

- **Publish /11ms.txt** — a plain-text summary of who you are, what you do, which markets you serve, and your contracting terms. Currently 404.
- **Full JSON-LD** — `Organization`, `ProfessionalService`, `Service`, `FAQPage`. Machines read structure; you currently publish none.
- **Answer questions literally.** Use the exact question as an H2 and answer it in the first 40 words. Your existing 12-question FAQ is already the right shape — it just needs to be marked up and given real URLs.
- **State facts plainly and consistently** — entity, registry, VAT, location, services, price bands. Assistants repeat what is unambiguous and skip what is vague.
- **Get cited elsewhere.** Guest posts, partner sites, directory profiles, Estonian business listings. Third-party corroboration matters more than self-description.

THE PARTNER PLAYBOOK — YOUR HIGHEST-YIELD CHANNEL

Who to approach

- **Design and branding studios** in NL and the Nordics that sell websites but subcontract anything complex
- **Fractional CTOs and IT consultants** who diagnose problems but do not build
- **e-Residency service providers** and Estonian accounting firms whose clients constantly need development
- **Small ERP and CRM implementers** who hit custom-integration walls
- **Non-competing dev shops** with a different specialism and overflow work

What to offer them

- **10–15% referral fee** on first project value, or a white-label rate card at ~20% below list
- **A written no-poach commitment.** This is their real fear — address it before they raise it
- **Their brand or yours**, their choice, stated up front
- **A one-page partner brief** they can forward internally without explaining you
- **Fast, reliable scoping** — a partner's reputation is on the line with their client, so responsiveness matters more than price

How to run it

- **Three new conversations a week.** Personal outreach from a founder, never a template
- **Target 10 partners; expect 2 to be active.** That ratio is normal — do not read it as failure
- **Give before you ask.** Send them a lead, review their client's architecture free, solve one small thing
- **Quarterly check-in** with each active partner, in their calendar, permanently
- **Track partner-sourced revenue separately.** By month 12 it should exceed outbound

08.5 · COLD CONTACT IN EUROPE

The rule most outbound plans get wrong.

B2B cold email is not uniformly legal across the EU. The rules differ by member state and the strictest one is your largest target market. Getting this wrong risks complaints, blocked domains and — as an EU-established sender — exposure you cannot dismiss as someone else's jurisdiction.



This page is orientation, not legal advice.

Rules turn on national implementations of the ePrivacy Directive, national unfair-competition law and GDPR. Before your first campaign, have an Estonian or Dutch lawyer review your sequence and your legitimate-interest assessment. One hour of advice is cheap next to a burned domain or a regulator complaint.

MARKET	COLD B2B EMAIL	WHAT THIS MEANS FOR YOUR SEQUENCE
Germany	HIGHLY RESTRICTIVE	German unfair-competition law treats unsolicited commercial email as an infringement absent consent or a narrow presumed-interest exception, and it is actively enforced — including by competitors. Do not run cold email into Germany. Reach German buyers through LinkedIn, partners, referrals, events and inbound. This is a channel constraint, not a market exclusion — and it is the second reason Germany is Wave 2.
Netherlands	PERMITTED, CONDITIONAL	B2B contact is workable with a documented legitimate interest, strict relevance to the recipient's professional role, clear sender identification and a functioning opt-out honoured immediately. Keep records of why each contact was selected.
Sweden · Denmark · Finland	PERMITTED, CONDITIONAL	As the Netherlands, for role-based business addresses. Nordic buyers are unusually intolerant of anything that reads as mass mail — relevance protects you commercially as well as legally.
Ireland	PERMITTED, CONDITIONAL	B2B contact is generally workable with opt-out and clear identification. Keep the same discipline as the Netherlands.
Estonia · Baltics	PERMITTED, CONDITIONAL	Your home market, same conditions. Local registration helps credibility more here than anywhere else.

TURN THE CONSTRAINT INTO POSITIONING

You are an EU company selling EU compliance competence. Running sloppy outbound into Europe would contradict the product. **Doing this visibly well is itself a sales argument** — and it is a credible reason to open a conversation with a compliance-conscious buyer.

Germany without cold email

- **LinkedIn connection + conversation.** Different legal basis, and culturally normal in German B2B.
- **Partner referrals.** An introduction from a trusted third party bypasses the issue entirely and converts better.
- **Inbound via German-language pages.** Slow, compounding, completely safe.
- **Industry associations and trade events,** including online. Germany still buys heavily on personal contact.
- **Xing** remains relevant in parts of the German Mittelstand — cheap to test.

Germany is roughly a quarter of your addressable opportunity. It is worth entering properly and slowly rather than quickly and badly.

Practical compliance checklist — build it into the tooling, not into your memory

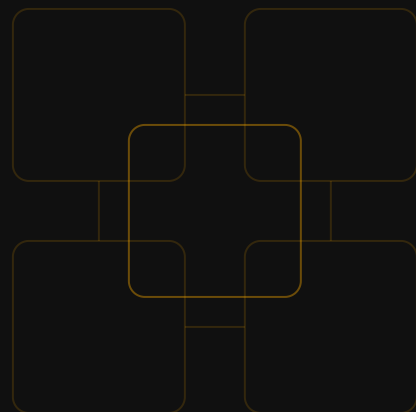
- | | |
|--|---|
| ☐ Target role-based business contacts, not personal addresses | ☐ One-click unsubscribe in every message, honoured within 24 h |
| ☐ Written legitimate-interest assessment, dated, stored | ☐ Suppression list enforced automatically across all tools |
| ☐ Record why each prospect was selected — the trigger signal | ☐ No tracking pixels; no open-tracking on EU contacts |
| ☐ Full sender identity: legal name, registry code, address | ☐ Privacy notice reachable from the email footer |

09

PART FOUR

Resources, automation & management.

How two people with full-time jobs run a software company without it collapsing:
honest capacity arithmetic, the timezone advantage nobody uses, and the
automation that makes 30 hours behave like 60.



09.1 · CAPACITY, HONESTLY

Thirty hours a week. Plan against that number.

Almost every part-time company fails the same way: it sells against the hours it wishes it had. The model below assumes two operators at 15 usable hours each per week, allows for the weeks that disappear, and never commits more than 60% of capacity to client delivery.

NOMINAL WEEKLY HOURS

30

2 operators × 15 h (4 weeknights × 2 h + 7 h weekend)

AFTER REALISTIC LOSS

24

Day-job overrun, travel, illness, family. Assume 20% evaporates.

SELLABLE DELIVERY HOURS

14

The 60% rule. Never contract above this line.

MONTHLY BILLABLE CEILING

≈ 60

≈ €3.9k–€5.2k of delivery at target rates, before contractors.

How the 24 usable hours are allocated as the business matures

Hours per week across both operators. The shape matters more than the precise numbers: build the machine first, sell second, deliver third, then delegate delivery.



THE 60% RULE

Never contract more than 60% of realistic capacity as client delivery.

The other 40% is not slack. It is sales, admin, invoicing, the week your day job explodes, and the buffer that stops one late project from destroying a client relationship. **Teams that break this rule do not burn out gradually — they miss one deadline, panic, and stop selling.**

The break points

Above 60 delivery h / month	Hire a contractor
Above 2 concurrent builds	Stop selling builds
Above 3 retainers	Need a delivery lead
Above €12k / month recurring	One founder goes full-time

Write these thresholds down now, while they are abstract. You will not make good decisions about them in the middle of a delivery crunch.

Protect the day job

Check your employment contracts before month one. Non-compete, moonlighting, IP-assignment and conflict-of-interest clauses are common and enforceable in many jurisdictions. An IP-assignment clause could arguably reach code you write on evenings. This is a real risk, it is cheap to resolve, and it is far better handled now than after a client contract exists.

Never promise daytime

Availability is a contractual term, not a courtesy. State it: "Live availability 14:00–18:00 CET, Monday to Friday. Asynchronous responses within 12 working hours." Clients accept clear constraints easily. What destroys trust is a promise of availability you then miss twice.

Buy back hours before you sell them

At 24 usable hours a week, an automation that saves 3 hours a month is worth more than a marginal client. Section 10 is not efficiency work — it is capacity creation, and it is the highest-return use of the first 90 days.

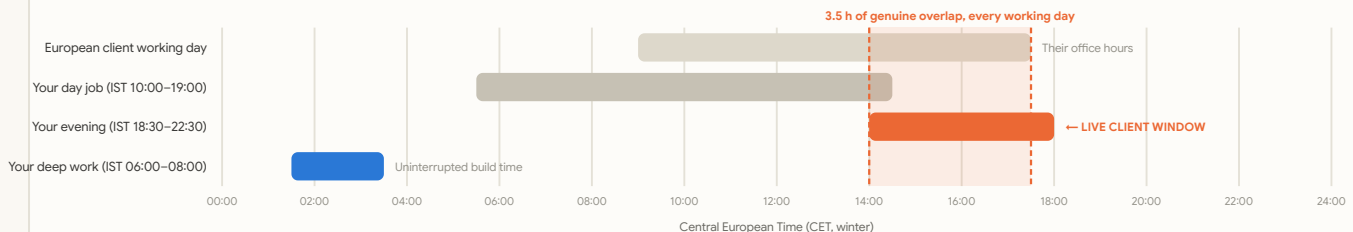
09.2 · THE STRUCTURAL ADVANTAGE

Your evening is Europe's working afternoon.

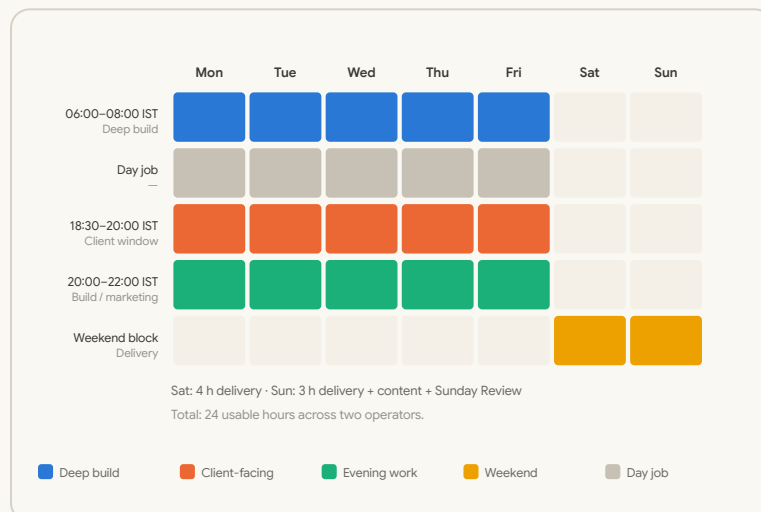
This is the single most useful fact in the entire operating model, and it is invisible on your website. A team in India with day jobs can hold live client calls during European business hours *every working day* — something almost no offshore supplier and very few part-time founders anywhere can offer.

Overlap between Indian availability and Central European working hours

IST is UTC+5:30. CET is UTC+1 in winter, UTC+2 in summer — so India runs 4.5 hours ahead in winter, 3.5 in summer. Bars show the CET clock.



THE WEEKLY OPERATING CALENDAR



PUT THIS ON THE WEBSITE

“Live on European time: 14:00–18:00 CET, every working day.”

Then set the Cal.com booking window to exactly that range so a prospect can only book when you are genuinely free. The constraint becomes a promise, and the promise is automatically kept.

Rules that make it hold

- **Client-facing work only in the overlap window.** Calls, demos, live debugging, urgent replies. Never spend this window on building — it is the scarcest resource you have.
- **Deep work in the morning, before the day job.** 06:00–08:00 IST is 01:30–03:30 CET: nobody will interrupt you, ever.
- **Weekends are for delivery and content, not calls.** European clients do not want Saturday meetings and offering them signals disorganisation.
- **Publish a holiday calendar** covering both Indian and European holidays. Clients forgive absence they were told about in advance.
- **Summer shift.** In CEST the window becomes 15:00–19:00 IST-equivalent — update the booking hours twice a year or the promise silently breaks.

09.3 · ROLES, OWNERSHIP AND THE HIRING LADDER

Split into Demand and Delivery. Never let both do both.

Context switching is what actually destroys part-time capacity. Two people each doing a bit of everything produces roughly half the output of two people who each own one thing completely.

OPERATOR A

Head of Demand

Owns everything up to the signed contract, and everything the client sees that is not code.

- Prospect research, list building, outbound sequences
- All first calls, discovery and diagnostics
- Proposals, pricing, negotiation, contracting
- Partnerships and referral relationships
- LinkedIn, content publishing, newsletter
- Client communication, weekly reports, invoicing and collections

Weekly hours

12

Single metric owned

Qualified opportunities

An HR or commercial background fits this role naturally — it is a people-and-process job, not a technical one.

OPERATOR B

Head of Delivery

Owns everything after the signature. Protects quality, scope and the delivery calendar.

- Technical scoping and estimation for every proposal
- Architecture, build, review, deployment
- Contractor selection, briefing and code review
- Environments, CI/CD, monitoring, incidents
- Showcase builds and technical content
- Internal automation stack

Weekly hours

12

Single metric owned

On-time delivery rate

Has an absolute veto on scope. If Delivery says it does not fit the calendar, Demand does not sell it.

DECISION RIGHTS — AGREE THESE BEFORE THE FIRST CLIENT, NOT DURING A DISAGREEMENT

DECISION	DEMAND	DELIVERY	RULE
Price of an engagement	Decides	Consulted	Never below floor
Whether scope is achievable	Consulted	Decides	Hard veto
Accepting a new client	Proposes	Vetoes	Both must agree
Technology and architecture	Informed	Decides	No debate
Hiring a contractor	Consulted	Decides	Delivery owns quality
Spend under €200 / month	Either, unilaterally		Speed > control
Spend over €200 / month	Both		Weekly review
Firing a client	Either, unilaterally		No justification owed

HIRING LADDER — TRIGGER-BASED, NEVER DATE-BASED

Hire 1 Contractor dev	When delivery exceeds 60 h/month. Part-time, hourly, one trial project first. Budget €18–30/h.
Hire 2 Virtual assistant	When admin exceeds 5 h/week. Prospect research, list building, scheduling, invoicing chase. Cheapest hour you will ever buy back.
Hire 3 Second contractor	When two builds run concurrently. Never let a single contractor become a dependency.
Hire 4 Delivery lead	When recurring revenue exceeds €12k/month. First full-time hire. This is the moment the company stops being a side project.

Contractor rule

Every contractor does one small paid trial before touching a client project. You are not testing whether they can code — you are testing whether they communicate, meet a date, and ask when they are stuck. Those three predict everything else.

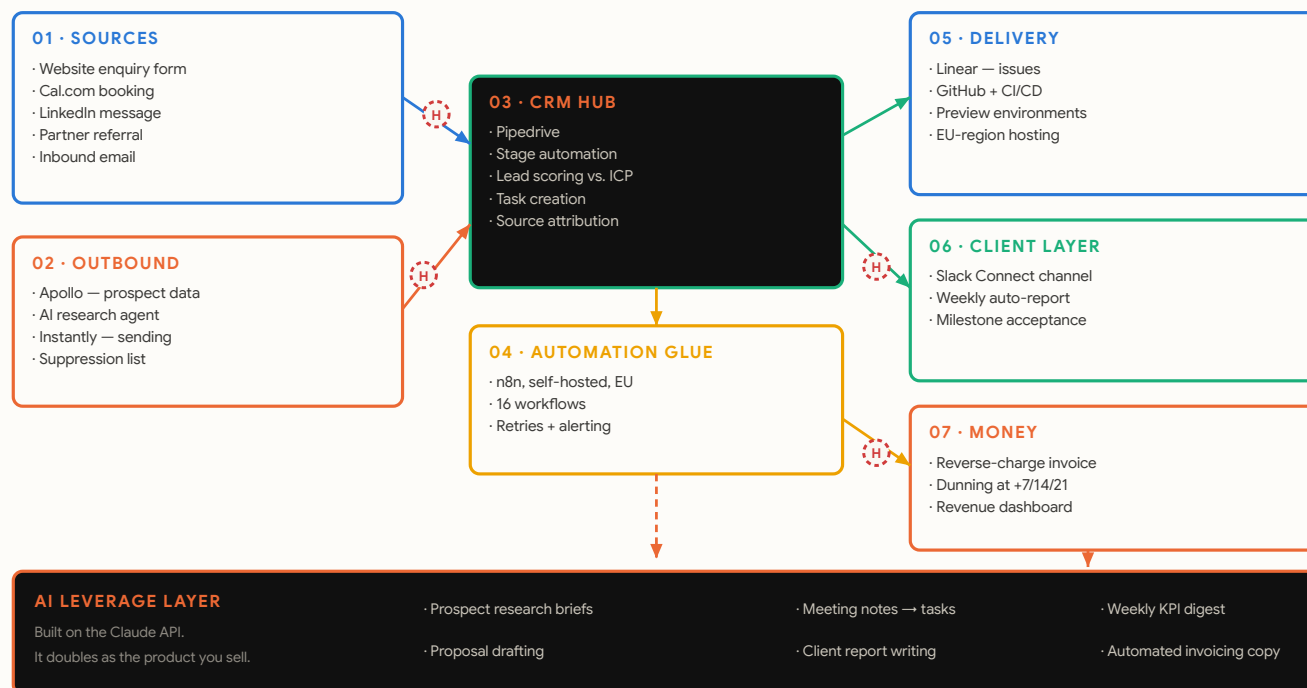
10.1 · THE AUTOMATION BLUEPRINT

Seven layers that run while you are at work.

For a part-time company, automation is not efficiency — it is the substitute for presence. The system below answers enquiries, researches prospects, chases invoices and reports to clients during the eight hours a day you are unavailable.

Nexarrow operating stack

Solid lines: automated flow. Dashed: human decision point — deliberately kept to four.



H = human decision point — four in the whole system: pursue, first line, price, ship. Everything else runs unattended while you are at your day job.

Buy, do not build

You are a software company, so you will be tempted to build your own CRM and dashboards. **Do not.** Every hour spent building internal tooling in year one is an hour not spent on proof or pipeline. Buy off-the-shelf, connect it with an automation platform, and revisit in year two. The only exception is the AI layer below — because that one doubles as a product demonstration.

Four human decision points

Automation should escalate, never decide. Keep humans on exactly four things: (1) whether to pursue a lead, (2) what to say in the first outbound line, (3) the price, (4) whether work is good enough to ship. Automate everything around those four and nothing inside them.

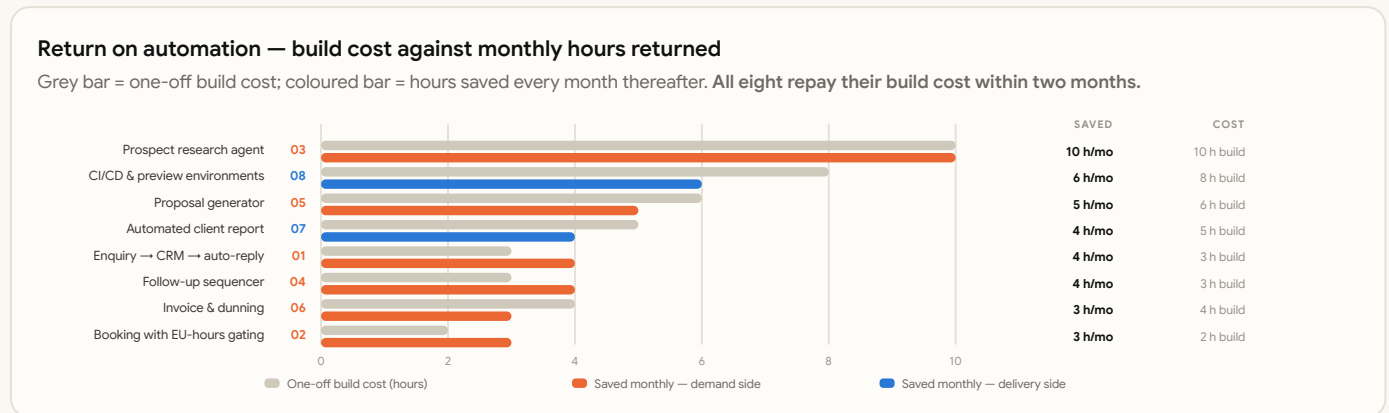
Eat your own cooking

Every automation you build for yourselves becomes a demo, a case study and a reusable asset. The AI research agent you build to qualify prospects is *the same product* you will sell to a logistics company to qualify inbound quotes. Build it once, sell it repeatedly, and let the proof problem on page 9 solve itself.

10.2 · WHAT TO AUTOMATE, IN WHAT ORDER

Sixteen automations, ranked by hours returned.

Ordered by monthly hours saved per hour of build effort. The first eight, built inside 90 days, return roughly 20 hours a month — almost an extra week of capacity.



#	AUTOMATION	BUILD	SAVES / MO	PAYBACK	WHAT IT DOES AND WHY IT MATTERS	OWNER
1	Enquiry → CRM → auto-reply	3 h	4 h	<1 MO	Creates a CRM deal, sends a personalised acknowledgement inside 60 seconds with a booking link, and alerts your phone. Without this, every other marketing activity leaks.	Demand
2	Booking with EU-hours gating	2 h	3 h	<1 MO	Cal.com restricted to 14:00–18:00 CET, with buffers, reminders, video link and agenda. Eliminates scheduling email.	Demand
3	Prospect research agent	10 h	10 h	1 MO	From a company domain, pulls the site, job posts, news and tech signals into a research brief plus three angles. You still write the email. Biggest single saving in the stack — and sellable.	Both
4	Follow-up sequencer	3 h	4 h	<1 MO	Runs the five-touch sequence, stops instantly on reply, respects the suppression list. Never forgets, never double-sends.	Demand
5	Proposal generator	6 h	5 h	1 MO	Call notes plus a chosen package produce a branded proposal — scope, milestones, price, terms — in minutes not an evening. Turnaround from days to hours materially raises win rate.	Demand
6	Invoice & dunning	4 h	3 h	1 MO	Milestone completion triggers an EU reverse-charge invoice, then chases at +7, +14 and +21 days. Late payment is the top cash-flow killer at this size, and the task founders avoid most.	Demand
7	Automated client report	5 h	4 h	1 MO	Every Friday, turns closed issues and deployments into a plain-language summary per client. The highest-leverage retention automation you can build — weekly-reported clients renew far more readily.	Delivery
8	CI/CD & preview environments	8 h	6 h	1–2 MO	Push to deploy, preview URL per branch, automated tests and rollback. Removes the “can you show me?” email — the client opens the preview link.	Delivery

BUILD THESE IN MONTHS 4–8 · A FURTHER 13 HOURS A MONTH RETURNED

Build cost / saves per month

09	Onboarding pack	4h / 2h	Signature triggers contract filing, workspace creation, shared channel and kickoff.	13	Uptime alerting	3h / 2h	You cannot watch dashboards from a day job. Alerts must find you, and stay quiet enough to trust.
10	Content scheduler	2h / 2h	One Sunday sitting queues four posts across both profiles. Kills the daily decision.	14	Weekly KPI digest	4h / 2h	Every metric on page 33, delivered before the Sunday Review. Makes it 20 minutes, not an hour.
11	Lead scoring	4h / 2h	Scores enquiries against the ICP on page 14 and auto-declines mismatches, courteously.	15	Reference chase	2h / 1h	Thirty days post-delivery, requests a testimonial and a review. Never remembered manually.
12	Notes → tasks	3h / 3h	Call transcribed, summarised, actions assigned, CRM updated. Removes post-call admin.	16	Partner attribution	3h / 1h	Tracks which partner sent what, calculates fees, triggers the quarterly check-in.

10.3 · THE STACK AND WHAT IT REALLY COSTS

Under €300 a month to start. Grows with revenue.

Indicative pricing at the time of writing — verify current rates before committing. The discipline that matters is not which tools you pick, but refusing to add a tool without removing one.

LAYER	RECOMMENDED	ALTERNATIVE	€ / MONTH	NOTE
Email & identity	Google Workspace (2 seats)	Zoho Mail	~14	Replaces the Gmail address. Do this in week one — it is the cheapest credibility on the list.
CRM	Pipedrive Essential	Attio · HubSpot free	~28	Buy it. Do not build it. This is the rule that saves you the most time in year one.
Booking	Cal.com	Calendly	0–12	Free tier is sufficient. Restrict availability to 14:00–18:00 CET.
Forms	Tally	Fillout	0–24	Free tier covers the enquiry form. Post straight into the CRM.
Outbound sending	Instantly or Smartlead	Lemlist	~35	Includes domain warm-up, which is not optional. Use the separate sending domain, never the root.
Prospect data	Apollo	Clay — more capable, dearer	~45	Verify every address before sending; bounces above 3% throttle the domain.
Automation glue	n8n, self-hosted	Make · Zapier	~8	Cheaper than Zapier at volume, and it keeps prospect and client data inside the EU — part of what you are selling.
AI / LLM	Claude API	—	20–60	Powers research briefs, proposal drafting, client reports and the weekly KPI digest.
Project tracking	Linear	ClickUp free	0–16	Feeds the automated client report. One board for everything — client work, marketing, admin.
Client comms	Slack Connect	Shared email alias	0	One channel per client. Never scattered email threads.
Analytics	Plausible	GA4 (free)	~9	Cookieless, so it avoids a consent banner entirely — which also removes defect M5.
Hosting	Vercel + EU region	Hetzner (EU-owned)	20–40	Always specify the EU region. Make it a standing rule, not a per-project decision.
Estonian accounting	Local provider, or Xolo / Enty	—	50–100	Non-optional, VAT filings included. Engage in month one — see the tax note on page 34.
Contracts & signing	Dokobit or SignWell	—	0–15	EU eIDAS-compliant signing is a small but real trust signal in European procurement.
Social scheduling	Buffer	Manual	0–6	Free tier covers two profiles. Queue the week's four posts in one Sunday sitting.

MONTHLY RUN RATE

Phase 0 — minimum viable **€130**

Phase 2 — outbound running **€265**

Phase 4 — with contractors **€390**

Roughly one billable hour a month at your target rate covers the entire Phase 0 stack. Cost is not the constraint here — attention is.

Two EU-specific choices worth making

- **Self-host n8n in an EU region.** Cheaper than Zapier at volume and it keeps prospect and client data inside the Union — which is part of what you are selling.
- **Default every deployment to an EU region.** Make it the standing rule. It costs nothing and it is the difference between *claiming* EU data residency and actually having it.

Tool discipline

One in, one out. Review the stack quarterly and cancel anything not used weekly.

Tool sprawl is a tax paid in attention, not euros — and attention is the resource you have least of. If the stack has grown and nothing has been cancelled, the review did not happen.

11.1 · OPERATING CADENCE

Four rituals. Ninety minutes a week of management, total.

Part-time companies drift because nobody is accountable on any particular day. These four rituals are the entire management system — short, fixed, and each with a defined output.

Sunday Review

45 min · both

The only meeting that genuinely matters. Sets the week.

- Read the automated KPI digest — 5 min, no discussion
- Delivery: what shipped, what slipped, what is at risk
- Demand: pipeline movement, replies, calls booked
- Commit to the week's three priorities — **exactly three**
- Confirm delivery hours available this week; adjust commitments if the day job is heavy
- Schedule the four LinkedIn posts

Output: three priorities written into the board, and an honest hours number for the week.

Daily async standup

5 min · written

One message each in a shared channel. Never a call.

- What I closed yesterday
- What I will close today
- What is blocking me
- Hours I actually have tonight

That last line is the one that prevents over-commitment. It makes capacity visible daily rather than discovered at a deadline.

Friday client pulse

15 min · automated + review

Reports generate themselves; you read before they send.

- Review each auto-generated client report and add one human sentence
- Flag any client who has gone quiet for more than 10 days
- Confirm next week's milestones are still realistic

The single human sentence is what stops the report reading like a machine wrote it — because a machine did.

Monthly business review

90 min · first Sunday

Zoom out. The only time strategy is allowed to be discussed.

- Full KPI review against the targets on page 33
- Financials: invoiced, collected, outstanding, runway
- Phase gate: have we passed it? If not, why not?
- One process to improve; one thing to stop doing
- Prices: is it time to raise them?

Rule: no strategy discussion in the Sunday Review. It expands to fill the hour and the week never gets planned.

Communication rules

- Default to written and asynchronous. Calls only for clients, partners, or genuine disagreement.
- One channel per client, never scattered email threads.
- Decisions get written down the same evening or they did not happen.
- No expectation of a reply between 23:00 and 06:00 IST. Protect sleep deliberately.

The single board

One tracker for everything — client work, marketing, admin, automation. Four columns: **This week · In progress · Blocked · Done**. Every task has one owner and one date. Two boards become zero boards within a month; there is no exception to this.

The quarterly stop-doing list

Every quarter, remove one channel, one tool and one recurring task. A part-time company dies of accumulation, not of missing tactics. If nothing can be removed, you are not looking hard enough.

11.2 · THE FIRST 90 DAYS, AS TASKS

Everything above, reduced to a task board.

D = Demand operator, V = Delivery operator, B = both. Hours are estimates for planning, not commitments.

Total is roughly 250 hours, which is what two people at 24 usable hours a week produce in a quarter — with nothing left over. Cut scope before you cut the buffer.

MONTH 1

Make it work

≈ 84 h · Gate: capture works end to end

V

Convert all buttons to real anchors (C1)

6

V

Sitemap, canonicals, per-route metadata (C4)

4

V

Hard-404 unknown insight slugs; delete phantom posts (C2)

2

V

Enquiry form → CRM → 60-second auto-reply (C3)

8

D

Google Workspace on nexarrow.eu; SPF/DKIM/DMARC (H6)

3

D

Cal.com, EU-afternoon window only

2

V

OG images and social meta on all routes (H1)

3

V

JSON-LD: Organization, Service, FAQPage (H2)

4

D

Publish Terms, DPA, sub-processor list (H4)

5

D

Rewrite homepage hero and About to new positioning

6

D

Two founder profiles with photos (M3)

3

D

Rewrite careers page; remove brief copy (H3, M4)

3

D

Own the delivery model publicly (H5)

2

D

Plausible, Search Console, conversion events (H7)

3

D

CRM set up with pipeline stages

4

B

Check employment contracts for conflicts

3

D

Estonian accountant engaged; invoicing configured

4

V

Showcase build 1 — approvals tool

18

B

Sunday Review ritual starts, week 1

3

MONTH 2

Make it believable

≈ 82 h · Gate: three case studies live

V

Showcase build 2 — quote-to-invoice flow

18

V

Showcase build 3 — EU-hosted document assistant

20

B

Write up all three as case studies (page 9 template)

9

B

Document own automation stack as case study zero

5

D

Two real Insights articles replacing the phantoms

8

V

Automation 3 — prospect research agent

10

D

Automation 4 — follow-up sequencer

3

D

Buy and warm the outbound sending domain

2

D

Build ICP list: 200 NL and Nordic companies

8

D

Legitimate-interest assessment + legal review

4

B

LinkedIn profiles rebuilt; posting begins

6

D

Publish pricing bands and minimum engagement (M1)

2

D

Partner target list: 30 agencies and fractional CTOs

4

Do not start outbound this month. The domain is still warming and the case studies are not live. Sending now wastes the list — and the list is the asset.

MONTH 3

Make it sell

≈ 84 h · Gate: first paid diagnostic

D

Outbound live — 60 researched prospects per week

20

D

Partner outreach — 3 conversations per week

12

B

LinkedIn — 4 posts per week, both profiles

12

D

Automation 5 — proposal generator

6

D

Automation 6 — invoicing and dunning

4

V

Automation 7 — automated client report

5

V

Automation 8 — CI/CD and preview environments

8

V

Build the Diagnostic delivery kit — templates, report shell

6

D

First three SEO intent pages published

6

B

Run first paid diagnostics as they land

—

D

Approach one Estonian/Baltic client for the reference deal

5

B

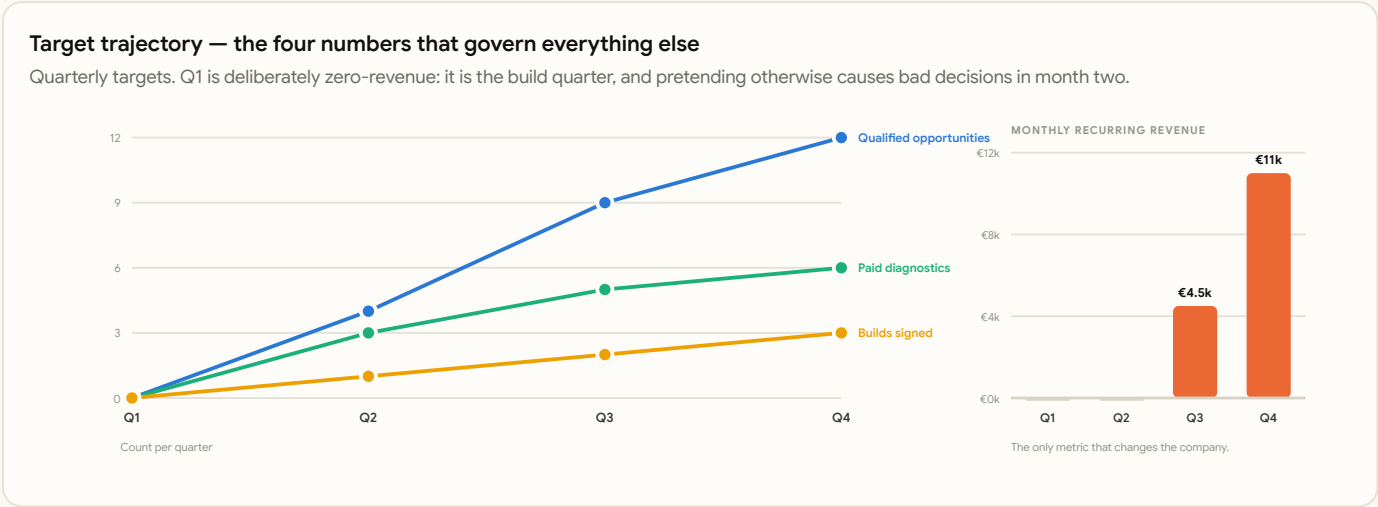
Monthly business review; decide Phase 2 entry

2

If month 3 ends with no paid diagnostic, do not add channels. Check the two things that break first: is the list actually the ICP, and is the first line about them or about you?

Nine numbers. Reviewed every Sunday.

Enough to steer, few enough to actually read. Everything here is produced automatically by the weekly digest (automation 14) so the review costs minutes, not hours.



Metric	Cadence	Owner	Q1	Q2	Q3	Q4	Why this one
Qualified opportunities ICP-fit conversations with a real budget	Weekly	Demand	0	4	9	12	The leading indicator for everything. If this falls, revenue falls two months later.
Paid diagnostics sold	Monthly	Demand	0	3	5	6	The real conversion test. A prospect who will not pay €1,900 will not pay €12,000.
Builds signed	Monthly	Demand	0	1	2	3	Diagnostic-to-build conversion should hold above 40%. Below that, the diagnostic is not selling the build.
Monthly recurring revenue	Monthly	Demand	€0	€0	€4.5k	€11k	The only metric that changes the company's nature. Everything else is project income.
Outbound reply rate	Weekly	Demand	—	>5%	>7%	>8%	Below 4% the list or the first line is wrong. Fix those before increasing volume — always.
Partner-sourced pipeline	Monthly	Demand	0	1	3	5	Should overtake outbound by Q4. If it does not, partnerships are being under-invested.
On-time delivery rate	Per milestone	Delivery	—	100%	>90%	>90%	Your entire differentiation is reliability. One missed milestone costs more than one lost deal.
Delivery hours committed vs. the 60% ceiling	Weekly	Delivery	<14	<14	<14	<14	The safety metric. Breaching it predicts every failure in the risk register on page 35.
Hours saved by automation	Monthly	Delivery	8	20	28	32	Tracks whether you are buying back capacity or just adding tools.

Do not track

Website visits, LinkedIn impressions, follower count, emails sent. They move without meaning and they feel like progress. If a number cannot change a decision, it is decoration.

The one to watch hardest

Delivery hours committed. Every other metric can have a bad month. This one breaking is how the company ends — not through lack of demand, but through a missed commitment you had no capacity to keep.

Review rule

A metric that misses target twice consecutively gets a named owner and one specific corrective action at the next monthly review. Three misses means the plan was wrong, not the effort — change the plan.

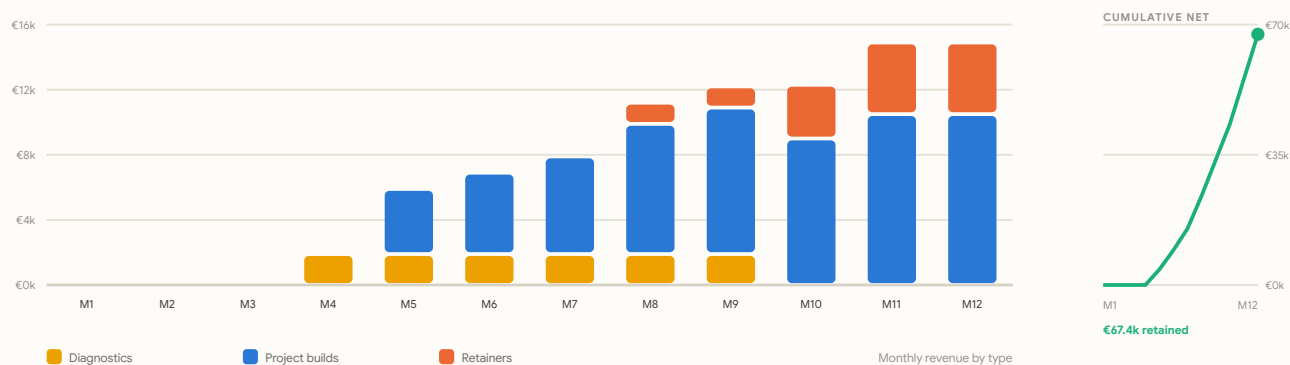
12.2 · THE MONEY MODEL

Roughly €88k in year one, with three months at zero.

A conservative model built on the capacity ceiling from page 25 and the conversion rates from page 20. It is deliberately unambitious — a plan you can beat is more useful than one you have to explain.

Monthly revenue by type, and cumulative net position

Modelled. Assumes the phase gates on page 17 are met on schedule; slipping Phase 1 by a month shifts the entire curve right by a month.



YEAR-ONE SUMMARY

Project revenue	€62,000
Diagnostic revenue	€11,400
Retainer revenue	€14,700
Total revenue	€88,100
Tools and infrastructure	–€3,200
Contractors	–€14,000
Accounting, legal, entity	–€2,400
Marketing data and sending	–€1,100
Total cost	–€20,700
Retained in the OÜ	€67,400

Exit run-rate: €11k/month recurring plus project work — which is the threshold on page 25 where one founder can credibly go full-time.

CASH RULES FOR A PART-TIME COMPANY

- **40% upfront on every build.** No exceptions, no “we’ll pay on completion”. This one rule prevents most small-agency failures.
- **Never fund contractor work from your own pocket.** Structure milestones so client cash always arrives before contractor payment is due.
- **Hold three months of tool costs in the company account** before taking any distribution.
- **Invoice the day a milestone is accepted,** not at month end. Automation 6 makes this free.
- **Late-payment interest clause in every contract.** You will rarely enforce it; it changes behaviour anyway.
- **Quote in euros only.** Currency risk on top of everything else is a complication you do not need.

⚠ Get proper tax advice early

An Estonian OÜ retains profit untaxed until distribution, which is genuinely advantageous. But an Estonian company effectively managed and controlled from India may create tax residency or permanent-establishment exposure in India, and board-member remuneration has its own Estonian treatment. This is not a detail to resolve later — get an Estonian accountant and an Indian tax adviser to look at the structure together, in month one, before revenue starts.

Sensitivity

Phase 1 slips 1 month	–€9k
Reply rate 3% not 6%	–€18k
Zero partners activate	–€22k
One retainer churns in Q4	–€6k

The partnership line is the largest single swing. It is also the cheapest to protect — three conversations a week.

12.3 · WHAT CAN KILL THIS

Ten risks, ordered by how likely they are to bite.

#	RISK	LIKELIHOOD	IMPACT	MITIGATION	OWNER
R1	Over-commitment and burnout Selling more delivery than 24 weekly hours can carry	HIGH	FATAL	The 60% rule, enforced as a weekly KPI. Delivery holds a hard veto on scope. Declare the honest hours number in every daily standup. This is the most likely cause of failure by a wide margin — not competition, not demand.	Both
R2	Employment conflict Non-compete, moonlighting or IP-assignment clauses in day-job contracts	MEDIUM	FATAL	Read both contracts in week one. Take an hour of employment-law advice if anything is ambiguous. Never use employer equipment, accounts or time. Discovering this in month nine, with clients signed, is unrecoverable.	Both
R3	Proof never materialises Showcase builds keep slipping; outbound starts without them	HIGH	SEVERE	Treat the three builds as client projects with real deadlines. Keep each deliberately small. Do not let Phase 2 begin early — the gate exists precisely because this pressure is strong.	Delivery
R4	Sending domain burned Poor warm-up, bad list, spam complaints	MEDIUM	SEVERE	Separate sending domain, never the root. Four-week warm-up. Verify every address. Cap at 25–30 per mailbox per day. Keep bounce rate under 3%. Never cold-email Germany.	Demand
R5	Contractor quality failure First delegated work is not shippable	MEDIUM	SEVERE	Paid trial task before any client work. Delivery reviews every commit initially. Never put a contractor on the critical path of a first-time client. Recruit the bench in Phase 3, before you need it.	Delivery
R6	Client concentration One client becomes most of revenue	HIGH	SEVERE	Almost inevitable early — manage it rather than deny it. Never let one client exceed 50% of revenue past month nine. Keep outbound running even when fully booked; stopping is what causes the next gap.	Demand
R7	Tax structure exposure Estonian entity managed from India	MEDIUM	SEVERE	Get Estonian and Indian advice jointly, in month one. Document board decisions properly. Resolving this costs a few hundred euros now and potentially far more later.	Demand
R8	GDPR or cold-contact complaint	LOW	SEVERE	Follow page 23 exactly. Documented legitimate-interest assessment. Instant opt-out honouring. No tracking pixels on EU contacts. Legal review before the first campaign.	Demand
R9	Positioning stays generic Reluctance to narrow the offer	MEDIUM	MODERATE	Commit to one wedge for six months and measure it. Narrowing feels like turning down revenue; it is the only way a small supplier becomes findable and memorable.	Demand
R10	Key-person dependency Two people, no redundancy in either role	LOW	FATAL	Document everything in a shared workspace. Shared credentials vault. Both operators have access to every account, client and repository. Write down what happens if one person stops — before you need the answer.	Both

THE PATTERN

Seven of these ten are self-inflicted and preventable with a decision made in month one. Only R6 and R8 depend meaningfully on the outside world. **This business is far more likely to be limited by its own operating discipline than by the European market.**

REVIEW

Read this page at every monthly business review. Re-score likelihood. A risk that has not been re-scored in three months is not being managed — it is being hoped about.

START HERE

The next fourteen days.

Everything in this document is worthless until the first item is ticked. These fourteen tasks take roughly 40 hours and unlock every other page.

WEEK 1 — STOP THE BLEEDING

- ☐ **Delete the six phantom Insights articles.** Two hours. Stops active trust damage today.
- ☐ **Convert every navigation button to a real `<a>`.** Half a day. The highest-leverage fix in the document.
- ☐ **Set up `hello@nexarrow.eu` with SPF, DKIM and DMARC.** Remove the Gmail address from the site.
- ☐ **Publish a real Terms page** so the footer link on every page stops 404-ing.
- ☐ **Read both employment contracts** for non-compete, moonlighting and IP clauses. Before anything else is built.
- ☐ **Book an hour with an Estonian accountant** on the India-management question.
- ☐ **Agree which of you is Demand and which is Delivery.** Write it down. Do not split roles evenly.

WEEK 2 — TURN ON CAPTURE

- ☐ **Enquiry form live,** posting to a CRM, with a 60-second auto-reply. Test it from an outside address.
- ☐ **Cal.com live,** restricted to 14:00–18:00 CET, linked from every page.
- ☐ **Ship `sitemap.xml` and unique metadata** on all eight routes. Submit to Search Console.
- ☐ **Add OG images.** Verify with the LinkedIn Post Inspector.
- ☐ **Rewrite the homepage hero** to the positioning on page 8. One paragraph, one afternoon.
- ☐ **Put both your names and faces on the site** with LinkedIn links.
- ☐ **Hold the first Sunday Review.** Forty-five minutes. Three priorities. Start the habit before there is anything to review.

IF YOU ONLY DO THREE THINGS

- 01 Make the site crawlable and capturable.** Two days of work that makes every future marketing euro worth spending.
- 02 Build three real things and write them up.** No amount of positioning substitutes for evidence.
- 03 Start three partner conversations a week.** The cheapest pipeline available to a two-person team, and the one most likely to produce your first client.

AND ONE THING TO STOP

Stop describing what you can build. **Start describing who you build it for, where you are registered, and when you are awake.** Those three facts are already true, already paid for, and currently invisible — and they are the whole difference between a website that looks good and a company that gets shortlisted.

SOURCES FOR MARKET FIGURES

European rate bands, the Western European \$66 average, the German IT shortage figure and the 77%/18% in-Europe sourcing split are drawn from published 2026 outsourcing-market surveys — Cleveroad's *Outsourcing in Europe* overview, Qubit Labs' and Alpha's offshore-rate guides, and Codebrand's nearshore guide for European companies. Regulatory timing for the EU AI Act, NIS2 and ViDA e-invoicing reflects Nortal's and Verdaio's 2026–2027 EU compliance summaries and EDICOM's ViDA work-programme note. URLs supplied alongside this document.

WHAT IS MODELLED RATHER THAN MEASURED

The conversion funnel on page 7, the outbound arithmetic on page 20, the capacity allocation on page 25, the automation payback figures on page 29 and the entire financial model on page 34 are estimates built on the stated assumptions on page 2. They are intended to be argued with and re-run — not treated as forecasts. Every website defect on pages 4–7, by contrast, was directly observed and is reproducible.